

THE PACT

Being the Compiled Law of the Silo,
Set Down for the Governance of All Its Citizens

As amended and continued
in the One Hundred and Fortieth Year
after the Founding

Published by order of the Office of the Mayor
and the Department of Judicial
for the instruction of every household

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Preamble

Read aloud at the naming of every child, at the seating of every Mayor, and at the opening of every school year, that none may say they did not know why they live as they live.

The world above is poison, and the world below is ours to keep. This is the whole of what our forebears left us to remember, and it is enough. Beyond that single fact, this Pact does not ask any citizen to hold the old world in mind at all — neither to mourn it nor to picture it nor to wonder after it — for such wondering has never once led anywhere good, and the Pact exists, before it exists to do anything else, to keep us from wandering there.

We are told, and it is sufficient to be told, that the air outside once turned against the people who breathed it, and that in the turning, nearly everything that had been built was lost. What remained of the builders' foresight was this: a shaft sunk deep into the earth, sealed against the poison above, stocked and engineered to hold generations of the living long enough for the world to heal, if it ever will. We do not know how long that healing will take. We are not to guess. Guessing has its own poison, and it moves faster underground than any vapor moves above.

The silo is not a shelter merely. It is a vessel with a hull, and a hull cannot be pierced in one place without the whole of it taking on water. Every rule that follows in this Pact — on birth, on labor, on speech, on punishment — exists to keep that hull whole for as many turns of the generations as it takes. We ask each citizen to hold this thought above all others: that the silo does not merely contain your life, it is the only reason you have one to live, and every citizen after you depends on your keeping of these laws exactly as every citizen before you depended on the keeping of them by others, most of whom you will never know by name, all of whom kept the silo alive so that you might stand here reading this. A citizen who keeps this Pact in full is sound, in the same word and the same sense a wall or a seal is sound, and the silo's whole endurance is

nothing more, and nothing less, than the sum of so many sound citizens as it can keep.

This is a Pact, and a Pact is a thing agreed to by more than one party. It is not handed down from a single hand, though it is set down by many hands together, to be amended in Assembly, argued over in Judicial, and tested against whatever winters of scarcity and years of grief the silo's generations must yet bear. It binds the Mayor no less than it binds the porter who carries her messages, the Head of Information Technology no less than the child not yet given a name. No officer of this silo, however seated, stands above it. Where any part of this Pact is silent, the silence is not permission; it is a gap to be carried to Judicial, and not filled by any one person's will.

We set down four founding truths, and every Article that follows serves one or more of them.

First, that the silo's people must go on, generation after generation, in numbers the silo can feed, warm, and air — no more, for the silo does not forgive a burden it cannot carry, and no fewer, for a silo that dwindles is a silo that dies alone. This is the whole reason for the lottery and for every law of birth and household that follows from it.

Second, that the silo's work must go on — the growing of food, the turning of the generator, the cleaning of the water, the keeping of the air — and that this work is not beneath any citizen and is owed by every citizen, in the place the silo's own methods of testing and shadowing determine each is best suited to give it. No family, no floor, no trade stands higher than another in the sight of this Pact, whatever any resident may privately believe about the floor above or below.

Third, that the silo's peace must go on. We are too many, packed too closely, with too little room to run from one another, to survive our own quarrels unrestrained. Every law of conduct, of property, of marriage, of dispute, and of punishment set down here exists only to keep neighbor from turning on neighbor, and floor from turning on floor, in a hull that cannot afford the turning.

Fourth, and hardest, that the silo's mind must go on. The old world is gone, and the wanting of it is a sickness that has taken good men and women both, quietly at first and then all at once. This Pact does not pretend such wanting can be legislated out of the heart. It only insists that it be kept out of the mouth, off the walls, and away from the young, so that longing does not become teaching, and teaching does not become a whole floor's grief, and a whole floor's grief does not become the silo's end. Where this Pact is sternest, it is sternest here, and it does not apologize for that.

Let it also be said, for it is said too rarely: this Pact is not cruelty

dressed as order. It is written by people who have buried their own dead and will raise their own children beneath its rule, and every hard clause in it is hard-won by someone's hard year, present or yet to come. It changes, by the lawful means set down in its final Article, when the silo's Assembly and its Mayor and its Judicial agree that it must, and it will change again, and again after that, for as long as the silo stands. What it does not do, and must never do, is disappear — for a silo with no Pact is not a silo with more freedom, only a silo with no floor beneath its feet.

Keep it, then, not because you were told to, but because you have read, here, exactly why.

Article 1

Of the Founding and Purpose of the Silo

In which is set down what every citizen is owed to know of why the silo stands, and to what end this Pact is written.

Section 1. The Recitation of the Founding

It is recorded, and shall be taught to every child before their eighth naming-day, that the air above was made poison to breathing things, and that in the time of that poisoning a great work was completed just in time to save some remnant of the people who built it: a shaft driven far down into the earth, sealed at its head, provisioned and engineered to keep its people fed, watered, warmed, and aired for longer than any single life, and longer, if need be, than any single family's memory of the ones who came before.

- (a) The air above is poisoned, and the silo stands sealed and provisioned to outlast the poison itself. This Pact is written to govern the silo so long as it stands and citizens dwell within it. No citizen is required to know more of the founding than this.
- (b) The precise manner of the poisoning above, the number and names of the founders, and the full account of the silo's building are not restated in full here. What a citizen is owed is this: that the silo was built in earnest, by people who meant for it to last, and that it has lasted because those who came after kept faith with what they were given.

- (c) No citizen is required to believe more of the founding than is here recorded, and no citizen shall be made to suffer for professing ignorance of any detail beyond it. A citizen shall suffer, however, for inventing detail beyond it and teaching that invention to others as though it were known fact; see Article 16, Section 3.

Section 2. The Purpose and Supremacy of this Pact

This Pact is the whole of the silo's public law. It governs every floor, every trade, and every citizen from the Up Top to the Down Deep, without exception of birth, office, or seniority.

- (a) Where this Pact speaks plainly, no local custom, floor tradition, or departmental rule may contradict it. Where this Pact is silent, a matter shall be carried to Judicial for a ruling, and that ruling shall thereafter bind as though it were written here, until such time as the Assembly amends this Pact directly under Article 23.
- (b) This Pact binds the Mayor, the Sheriff, the Head of every Department, and every appointed or elected officer of the silo exactly as it binds any other citizen. No office excuses its holder from any duty or punishment set down in this Pact, save where an Article expressly grants an officer some further power in the conduct of that office, and then only for so long as the office is held.
- (c) This Pact shall be kept in printed form in the Judicial archive, in the office of the Mayor, in the Sheriff's station, and in no fewer than one copy per twenty floors, placed in a hall or landing where any citizen may read it freely and without charge. No citizen may be denied sight of this Pact for any reason.
- (d) Ignorance of this Pact excuses no violation of it, save where this Pact itself provides a warning or grace as the first measure of correction, as in Article 17.

Section 3. The Structure of the Silo

The silo is built of one hundred and forty-four levels, joined by a single spiral stair at its center, and by no other common passage between floors save the freight lift reserved to Supply and Mechanical under Article 9.

- (a) The uppermost levels, known to all as the Up Top, hold the cafeteria and its great wallscreen, the offices of the Mayor and Deputy Mayor, the station of the Sheriff, the Department of Judicial, and the classrooms of the young.
- (b) The levels beneath, extending through the greater body of the silo and known together as the Mid Thirties, the Mids, and onward by their numbers, hold the bulk of the silo's housing, its markets, its hydroponic farms, its infirmary, and the trades that serve the whole of the silo's daily life.
- (c) The lowest levels, known to all as the Down Deep, hold Mechanical, the generator, water treatment, the workings of Mines, and the deep storage of the silo's reserves.
- (d) No citizen shall dig, bore, blast, or otherwise open any passage through floor, ceiling, or wall not already provided by the silo's builders, save under direct order of the Head of Mechanical acting within Article 9, and no such order may be given without the joint knowledge of the Mayor. This prohibition stands regardless of purpose, curiosity, need, or claimed emergency.
- (e) The stairwell belongs to every citizen equally and shall not be blocked, gated, or reserved to any floor, trade, or person, save for the passage of a work crew under posted notice and for no longer than the work requires.

Section 4. The Sensors and the Wallscreen

The silo maintains, at its uppermost level, a wallscreen upon which is shown, without interruption, the view of the world above as it is gathered by the silo's outward sensors.

- (a) This display stands as a plain reminder of the reason the silo exists and the reason its laws are kept, and it is not to be covered, shuttered, or switched dark for any purpose save the maintenance described below.
- (b) The upkeep, cleaning, and repair of the outward sensors is a duty of the Department of Information Technology, exercised under such further procedure as that Department alone is instructed in. This Pact does not set down that procedure here, for it is not a matter of ordinary citizenship; it is enough for every citizen to know that

the image shown is kept as true as it can be kept, at real cost, by real hands.

- (c) No citizen may tamper with, obstruct camera access to, or attempt private repair of the outward sensors. This is treated, without exception, as among the gravest offenses under Article 17.

Section 5. The Citizen Bound

Every person born within the silo, and every person who has taken the citizen's oath before Judicial upon reaching their majority, is a citizen for every purpose of this Pact, and remains so for the whole of their life, in every floor they are assigned to and every trade they are called to serve.

- (a) Citizenship is not sold, inherited as property, or transferred. It is a standing each person holds directly under this Pact, from naming to death.
- (b) A citizen's obligations under this Pact do not lessen with age, save where an Article expressly provides for the treatment of children or of the retired, as in Article 13 and Article 19.

Article 2

Of Citizenship and the Census

In which is set down how a citizen is named, how a citizen comes into full standing, and how the silo keeps account of its own numbers, that none may be forgotten and none counted twice.

Section 1. The Standing of a Citizen

Citizenship, as Article 1 sets down, belongs to every person born within the silo and to every person who has taken the citizen's oath before Judicial upon reaching majority. This section and those that follow set down how that standing is entered, kept, and closed.

- (a) Majority is reached upon a citizen's sixteenth naming-day.
- (b) A citizen not yet of majority is a ward of the household or floor to which they are assigned, and holds every duty this Pact lays upon a citizen of their years, but not the standing to swear before Judicial, to enter the lottery under Article 3, to speak in Assembly under Article 20, or to hold office.
- (c) No citizen may be stripped of citizenship for any cause. A citizen may be sent to cleaning under Article 18, or otherwise punished under Article 17, but remains a citizen, named in the rolls, until death is recorded under Section 5.

Section 2. The Naming of Children

A child born without the lottery's grant under Article 3 is not thereby refused a name or entry into the rolls, but the citizens responsible for that birth are answerable under Article 17.

- (a) Every child shall be named and entered into the rolls within ten days of birth, in a naming recorded by Judicial and attested by the delivering physician or midwife.
- (b) A child's naming-day is reckoned from the day of naming, not the day of birth, and every observance this Pact ties to a naming-day — schooling under Article 15, majority under this Article, testing and shadowing under Article 13 — is reckoned from it.
- (c) A child not named within ten days of birth shall be named regardless, upon inquiry by Judicial, and no delay in naming shortens or lengthens any citizen's later years of majority, testing, or retirement.

Section 3. The Citizen's Oath

Upon a citizen's sixteenth naming-day, that citizen shall present before Judicial and swear the citizen's oath: to keep this Pact, to bear the labor given, and to hold the silo's peace above their own — the same oath every citizen before them has sworn, without exception, since the first citizen stood where they now stand, and the same oath every citizen after them will swear in turn.

- (a) A citizen who cannot present for the oath by reason of illness, distance of floor, or the press of labor may swear it before a deputy of Judicial sent for that purpose, but no citizen's majority is delayed beyond one turn of the season for want of the ceremony alone.
- (b) The oath once sworn is not sworn again, whatever office a citizen later holds or loses.

Section 4. The Keeping of the Rolls

Judicial shall keep, for every living citizen, a roll recording that citizen's name, naming-day, floor and household of assignment, and trade, and shall issue to every citizen of majority an occupant card bearing the same, to be shown when Judicial, the Sheriff, Housing, or Supply require it.

- (a) Housing, Supply, and every Head of Department shall report to Judicial, within ten days, any change to a citizen's floor, household, or trade, that the rolls may be kept current; Judicial is not charged to seek out such changes on its own account, and relies upon these reports being made in good faith.
- (b) The full count of the rolls, and no other number, is the silo's population for every purpose of this Pact, including the granting of a lottery under Article 3 and the setting of the ration under Article 11.
- (c) A citizen who believes the rolls to record them in error may petition Judicial for correction; Judicial's finding on such a petition is final.

Section 5. Death and the Closing of a Name

A citizen's name is entered in the rolls at naming and closed in the rolls at death, and it is this closing, and no other event, that opens a place in the lottery under Article 3.

- (a) A citizen's death shall be recorded by Judicial upon the attestation of a physician under Article 19, or, where a citizen is sent to cleaning under Article 18, upon the word of the Department of Information Technology that the sensors were kept.
- (b) No citizen may be recorded as dead while living, nor as living while dead, and a citizen found to have made a false attestation under this section is treated among the gravest offenses under Article 17.
- (c) A death suspected by the attending physician to have come by the citizen's own hand, and not sought and granted under Article 18, shall not be closed upon the physician's attestation alone, but shall be carried to Judicial for a finding under Article 6 before the name is closed.

Article 3

Of Marriage, the Lottery, and the Right of Birth

In which is set down the marriage bond, the lottery by which the silo permits the bearing of children, and the right of every citizen to petition to be a parent, subject to the silo's need to preserve its population in balance.

Section 1. The Marriage Bond

A marriage is a partnership of two citizens, contracted before Judicial and entered into the rolls under Article 2, by which the two citizens become a household unit and are bound to each other and to the silo in such further duties as this Pact sets down. The marriage bond is the ordinary form by which two citizens declare their commitment to share labor, resources, and, where the lottery permits, the bearing and raising of children. It asks of each party a constancy the silo itself depends upon no less than it depends on breath and water: a household divided against itself cannot be trusted to raise a child in the silo's peace, and a silo built of divided households cannot be trusted to keep its own.

- (a) A marriage is dissolved only by the death of one of the parties, or by mutual petition granted by Judicial under such terms as Judicial finds just. A marriage dissolved remains entered in the Judicial archive, and does not erase the citizenship rolls of either party.
- (b) Two citizens may petition to be married before Judicial; Judicial shall not refuse such a petition save where one of the parties is already married or is a ward unable to consent under Article 2.

- (c) A marriage entered creates no obligation of children; the marriage bond stands as a household association alone, until and unless the partners petition the lottery under Section 2.
- (d) Housing shall accommodate married couples as married persons under Article 14, allocating housing by the partnership's size and needs rather than counting the two as separate residents.

Section 2. The Lottery for Children

The silo's population must remain within the bounds set by the silo's stores and the capacity of its Departments to provide for all its citizens. To this end, the bearing of children is governed by a lottery held once yearly: citizens may petition to bear a child, and the lottery selects from among the petitioners such number as the silo's population can sustain.

- (a) Any citizen, whether married or unmarried, or any partnership of two citizens married under Section 1, may petition to the lottery to be granted the right to bear a child. A petition shall name the petitioner(s) and the intended bearing parent, if different.
- (b) The lottery is drawn by Judicial, with the Mayor and the Head of Supply present, once yearly. The number of slots granted is set by the Mayor, in consultation with the Head of Supply and the Heads of other Departments, based on the silo's population capacity for the coming year as recorded in the census under Article 2.
- (c) A citizen granted a slot in the lottery receives the right to bear a child, and the mandatory birth-control measure, previously fitted, is deactivated for such time as permits one conception and bearing. The window for conception shall be no fewer than three seasons and no longer than one full year, at the direction of the Infirmary under Article 19.
- (d) A citizen who wins the lottery may gift or transfer the right to bear a child to a spouse, a sibling, or another citizen of their household, provided Judicial approves the transfer; such a transfer does not require the recipient to be married or partnered.
- (e) No citizen shall be compelled to bear a child, and the winning of a lottery slot does not obligate the winner to use it. A slot not used within the window of conception shall be forfeited, and the citizen's birth-control measure shall be re-activated.

Section 3. The Right of Birth and the Window of Conception

A citizen granted the lottery's right to bear a child must do so within the window of conception granted; outside this window, the child-bearing is unlicensed and unsanctioned. A child born within the window and properly attested shall be named and entered in the rolls under Article 2 as a full citizen.

- (a) A child conceived within the lottery window and born to a citizen holding the lottery right shall be named and entered in the census by Judicial within ten days of birth, exactly as any other citizen is named.
- (b) A child born to a citizen who did not win the lottery, or born outside the window of conception granted, is still a citizen and shall be named and entered in the rolls; but the citizen(s) responsible for the child's birth are answerable under Article 17, as set down in Section 3.
- (c) The Infirmary shall keep, for every citizen of bearing age, a record of the citizen's birth-control status and the dates of any lottery window granted. These records are kept in the Judicial archive under Article 6 and are available to Judicial for verification.

Section 4. Unsanctioned Children and the Answering for Unlicensed Birth

A child conceived and borne without the lottery's sanction is no less a citizen than any other; the child receives full standing, a name, and entry in the census. But the adult(s) responsible for the child's conception are answerable under Article 17 for the breach of the silo's population law.

- (a) The citizen(s) responsible for an unsanctioned child's conception shall be determined by Judicial, taking evidence from the child's birth records, the parent(s), and any other source; once responsibility is assigned, the responsible citizen(s) is answerable under Article 17.
- (b) The bearing of an unsanctioned child does not prevent a citizen from petitioning the lottery in future years; a citizen who has borne an unsanctioned child and is later granted a lottery slot may use it for a sanctioned bearing.

- (c) No child born outside the lottery shall be treated differently from any other citizen in the silo's law, ration, housing, or any other respect. The penalty applies to the responsible adult(s), not to the child.

Section 5. The Administration of the Lottery

The lottery is held once yearly, its slots are announced, and the process is kept in the Judicial archive under Article 6. The lottery is a matter of great consequence to every citizen, and transparency is the guard against favoritism or secret manipulation.

- (a) The lottery shall be drawn in the Assembly under Article 20, or at such place as the Assembly determines, and any citizen may witness the drawing. The names of the winners shall be announced publicly and entered in the Judicial archive.
- (b) A citizen who believes the lottery was conducted unfairly may petition Judicial for a ruling; Judicial may order the lottery re-drawn if sufficient cause is found.
- (c) The slots granted by the lottery are the sole means by which a citizen's birth-control measure may be deactivated. No other authority—not the Mayor, not a Department head, not Judicial itself—may order such deactivation.
- (d) A citizen denied a lottery slot may petition again in following years without penalty; the lottery is held once yearly without exception, and no citizen is permanently barred from petitioning.

Section 6. The Duty to Maintain the Population

The silo's survival depends on its population remaining stable across the generations. The lottery is the mechanism by which this balance is struck: the silo grows when deaths create new slots, and the silo sustains when births replace the dead. This balance is not a cruelty, but the silo's means of keeping every citizen fed and the works of the silo in motion for generations to come.

It is recorded, though not by the name of the household, that a citizen who waited three years for a lottery slot, and buried a stillborn child in the fourth, came before the Assembly and said that this balance, hard as

it had been to bear, was the same balance that had kept her own mother fed as a child, and asked that no citizen be spared the waiting who had not first been spared the alternative. This Pact does not require any citizen to feel as she felt. It asks only that every citizen know such a citizen has lived, and judged as she judged.

- (a) No citizen is deprived of the chance to bear a child by this Article alone; only the timing is constrained. Citizens who are denied slots in one year may petition in the next, and the lottery is held without fail, every year, for so long as the silo stands.
- (b) The capacity of the silo to support children is set by the Mayor and the Heads of Departments based on the census; as the silo's stores grow or shrink, as Departments expand or contract, the number of lottery slots may grow or shrink accordingly. The Mayor shall announce the year's slot count before the lottery is drawn.

Article 4

Of the Office of Mayor

In which is set down the office of the Mayor, the civilian head of the silo, and the powers by which this office governs in concert with Judicial and Assembly.

Section 1. The Office of Mayor

The silo is governed by a civilian Mayor, who stands as the highest executive authority of the silo, answerable to the Assembly under Article 20 and to the requirements of this Pact as set down in Article 1. The Mayor is chosen by election and confirmed into office through the process set down in Article 5. The Mayor resides and keeps the office in the Up Top, in the Mayor's chambers, alongside the office of the Deputy Mayor.

- (a) The Mayor is a citizen, subject to every duty this Pact lays upon any other citizen, save where an Article expressly grants the Mayor some further power or authority in the conduct of the office itself.
- (b) The Mayor holds office for such term as the Assembly determines under Article 20, and continues in office at the Assembly's pleasure, being removable by a vote of the Assembly as provided there.
- (c) In the absence or incapacity of the Mayor, the Deputy Mayor shall act as Mayor with all the powers of the office, for such time as the Mayor's absence continues, under Article 5.
- (d) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome may hold the office of Mayor or stand for confirmation to it. Any Mayor who falls afflicted with the Syndrome during their term shall immediately resign, and the Deputy Mayor shall assume the office under Article 5.

Section 2. The Mayor's Powers of Confirmation and Appointment

The Mayor, in concert with this Pact and the Assembly, holds the power to confirm the heads of every Department and the single Judge who heads the Department of Judicial. The Sheriff is appointed by the Mayor alone, though the Mayor shall weigh the advice of those in and out of the Sheriff's own office. In all cases, the Mayor's judgment is final, and no other office may override such confirmation or appointment once given.

- (a) The Mayor confirms the Head of each Department — Mechanical, Information Technology, Supply, Mines, and all others established under this Pact — by written order, countersigned by the head's own officer who recommended them (where such a recommendation exists), and filed in the Judicial archive under Article 6.
- (b) The appointment of the Sheriff is the sole discretion of the Mayor: the outgoing Sheriff may make a recommendation, and the Mayor shall hear it in good faith, but the Mayor is not bound by that recommendation and may appoint any citizen of majority, whether from within the Sheriff's office or without, as the new Sheriff sees fit.
- (c) The confirmation of the Judge is made jointly by the Mayor and the Assembly under Article 20; the Judge is confirmed once in lifetime and stands until death or removal by the Assembly.
- (d) No Mayor shall dismiss or remove a confirmed head of Department from office for cause of ordinary policy disagreement. Removal for cause requires a finding of Judicial that the head has violated the Pact or a major duty of the office; such findings are referred to the Assembly under Article 20 for final removal.

Section 3. The Mayor's Orders and Emergency Authority

The Mayor may issue standing orders, written and filed in the Judicial archive, directing the conduct of the silo's ordinary affairs in concert with the heads of the relevant Departments. No order of the Mayor may contradict this Pact, nor may any standing order be given in secret — all orders are entered in the records that any citizen may examine under Article 6. In the event of emergency, the Mayor holds further powers, set down in Article 22.

- (a) An order of the Mayor takes effect when issued and is binding on the head of the named Department; a Department head who disputes an order may refer the matter to Judicial for a ruling, and the order does not bind until Judicial has ruled.
- (b) The Mayor may not order any act that would require citizens to violate the Pact, nor direct the commission of any offense under Article 17. A citizen ordered to break the Pact may refuse the order and refer the matter to Judicial under Article 6.
- (c) The Mayor may make promises or take oath-bound obligations on behalf of the silo as a whole — as, for example, the division of resources in a time of extreme shortage, or a standing obligation laid upon a Department beyond the term of the Mayor who laid it — only with the consent of the Assembly, given under Article 20.
- (d) The Mayor directs the use of the silo’s major resource reserves (water, air, generator capacity, food stores) in ordinary times according to Article 11’s framework (the Head of Supply sets the ration under the Mayor’s general approval); in emergency, Article 22 governs.

Section 4. The Mayor and Judicial

The Mayor and the Department of Judicial are co-equal in authority over the silo’s law-making and law-executing functions, but with distinct roles: the Mayor commands the day-to-day operations and sets major policy; the Department of Judicial investigates offenses, tries accused citizens, and rules on the Pact’s meaning when it is silent. Neither office may command the other in the exercise of this Pact-given power.

- (a) The Mayor may refer a matter to Judicial for a ruling if the Pact is silent (Article 6’s procedure applies).
- (b) The Judge may, by written order, direct the Mayor to enforce a Judicial finding or to comply with a ruling made under Article 6; the Mayor must obey such a written order or refer the dispute to the Assembly under Article 20.
- (c) A dispute between the Mayor and Judicial over interpretation of the Pact is adjudicated by the Assembly under Article 20, which may convene an extraordinary session to resolve it.
- (d) The Mayor’s orders do not bind Judicial’s investigative or charging decisions; Judicial may investigate and charge any citizen, including

the Mayor, for any offense under Article 17 without the Mayor's leave or permission.

Section 5. The Mayor and the Assembly

The Mayor convenes the Assembly under Article 20 and sets its agenda, but does not control its votes or its business. The Mayor reports annually to the Assembly on the state of the silo. The Mayor may recommend amendments to this Pact (under Article 23), and the Assembly may initiate amendments without the Mayor's consent.

- (a) The Mayor is answerable to the Assembly for the conduct of the silo's affairs, and the Assembly may question the Mayor on any matter of policy or resource management.
- (b) No standing order, appointment, or decision of the Mayor binds the Assembly, and any citizen or the Assembly itself may petition for an extraordinary sitting to revisit a mayoral decision.

Section 6. The Office of Deputy Mayor and Succession

The Deputy Mayor is the second-highest office of the silo, charged with assisting the Mayor in the conduct of the office and with assuming the mayoralty should the Mayor die, become incapacitated, or be removed by the Assembly. The office of Deputy Mayor, the manner of the Deputy's own coming to it, and the whole order of succession are set down in full in Article 5, which this Article's other provisions bind exactly as they bind the Mayor's own office.

Section 7. The Forgiveness Holiday

The Mayor may declare a Forgiveness Holiday, of such duration and upon such notice as the Mayor sets, that a citizen holding a relic or restricted instrument or device forbidden under Article 16 may surrender it, in the manner that Article provides, without fear of answering for the mere keeping, making, or use of the thing surrendered.

- (a) A citizen who surrenders a relic or restricted instrument or device under Article 16 during a Forgiveness Holiday is not answerable

under Article 17 for the keeping, making, or use of the thing surrendered. The thing itself is examined and classified exactly as any other surrendered relic under Article 16, and a thing classified among the gravest is destroyed or sealed as that Article provides, whatever grace is given the citizen who surrendered it.

- (b) This grace covers only the keeping, making, or use of the thing surrendered, and no other offense the surrender, or Judicial's examination of the thing surrendered, may bring to light; a citizen who surrenders a relic is answerable exactly as any other citizen for any other violation of this Pact the surrender reveals.
- (c) A Forgiveness Holiday declared under this section is announced to the whole silo before it begins, that no citizen surrender in ignorance of the grace being offered, and its ending is announced with equal notice; a thing surrendered after a Forgiveness Holiday has ended is answered under Article 17 exactly as though no holiday had been declared.
- (d) The Mayor may declare a Forgiveness Holiday at such interval, and for such cause, as the Mayor judges the silo's peace to require, and need not state more than the fact of its declaration and its duration.

Article 5

Of the Deputy Mayor and the Order of Succession

In which is set down the office of the Deputy Mayor and the manner by which the silo chooses its next Mayor, that the office may never stand vacant and the silo's governance may never pass into uncertainty.

Section 1. The Office of Deputy Mayor

The Deputy Mayor is the second-highest office of the silo, subordinate to the Mayor in ordinary times. The Deputy Mayor's duty is to assist the Mayor in the conduct of the office and to hold in readiness the knowledge and authority to assume the Mayoralty should the sitting Mayor become unable to serve. The Deputy Mayor is appointed by the Mayor and confirmed by the Assembly under Article 20, serves at the Mayor's pleasure, and resides in the Up Top alongside the Mayor's chambers.

- (a) The Deputy Mayor holds every duty of a citizen under this Pact and is subject to the same law as any other citizen, save where this Article or Article 4 expressly grants the Deputy some authority in the conduct of the Deputy's office.
- (b) The Deputy Mayor has access to all records, correspondence, and standing orders of the Mayor's office, that the Deputy may be prepared at any moment to assume the Mayoralty without loss of continuity.
- (c) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome may hold the office of Deputy

Mayor or be confirmed to it. Any Deputy Mayor who falls afflicted with the Syndrome shall immediately resign, and the Mayor shall appoint a new Deputy, confirmed by the Assembly under this Article.

Section 2. The Deputy Mayor's Assumption of the Mayoralty

Upon the death of the sitting Mayor, or upon the Mayor's resignation, or upon the Mayor being removed from office by the Assembly under Article 20, the Deputy Mayor shall immediately assume the office and powers of the Mayor, and shall serve as Mayor until such time as a new Mayor is elected and confirmed under Section 3.

- (a) The Deputy Mayor, upon assumption of the Mayoralty, becomes bound by every requirement and power set down in Article 4 for the Mayor, and Article 4 governs the Deputy's conduct from the moment of assumption forward.
- (b) The Deputy Mayor assuming the Mayoralty may issue standing orders, manage the silo's resources, and carry out all ordinary functions of the Mayor's office, save one: the Deputy may make no permanent appointment of a Department head or the Judge. Such permanent appointments are deferred until a new Mayor is elected and confirmed.
- (c) The Deputy Mayor's acts in the conduct of the Mayoralty during assumption are valid and binding on the silo and may not be reversed upon the election and assumption of a new Mayor, save where this Pact or a ruling of Judicial requires otherwise.
- (d) If the Mayor is absent but not dead or removed — taken ill, sent as an envoy, or otherwise prevented from the conduct of office for a known or suspected duration — the Deputy acts as Mayor with all powers including the power to make temporary appointments, such temporary authority ceasing upon the Mayor's return.

Section 3. The Election for the Next Mayor

When the Mayoralty stands vacant by reason of death, resignation, or removal, an election shall be held. Any citizen of majority standing, with no debt to justice under Article 17 and no continuing sentence under

Article 17, may stand for election as Mayor. The Assembly shall conduct the election and determine the process of the same.

- (a) The Deputy Mayor, while serving as acting Mayor during the vacancy, may not stand for election to the Mayoralty, to ensure the impartiality of the acting office during the election itself.
- (b) A citizen elected to the Mayoralty must be confirmed by the Assembly under Article 20 before taking final office; confirmation shall not be withheld save for cause found by Judicial.
- (c) The newly elected and confirmed Mayor assumes office and all the powers of the Mayor under Article 4 upon confirmation; the Deputy Mayor's acting Mayoralty concludes at that moment.
- (d) The Assembly shall hold an election to choose and confirm the new Mayor; the Assembly, in consultation with the acting Mayor and the Heads of Departments, shall determine the timing and manner of the election.

Section 4. The Deputy Mayor's Election and Succession

The Deputy Mayor is appointed by the sitting Mayor and confirmed by the Assembly under Article 20. Should the Deputy Mayor die, resign, or be removed from office before the Mayoralty stands vacant, the Mayor shall appoint a new Deputy, confirmed by the Assembly, to fill the vacancy.

- (a) A new Deputy Mayor may be appointed at any time the sitting Mayor judges needful, and no more than one Deputy may serve at a time.
- (b) Should both the Mayor and the Deputy die or be removed simultaneously or in succession before a new Mayor can be elected, the highest-ranking Department head, determined by the order of their first confirmation in office, shall assume the Mayoralty as acting Mayor until the election is held and a new Mayor confirmed.

Article 6

Of Judicial and the Courts

In which is set down the charge of Judicial: to rule where this Pact is silent, to judge where it is broken, and to keep, in one place, the record of how both are done.

Section 1. The Charge and the Judge

Judicial is charged with the judging of every offense under this Pact, the ruling of every matter this Pact leaves silent, and the keeping of the silo's Judicial archive, and holds its offices Up Top as Article 1 sets down.

- (a) Judicial is led by a Judge, confirmed in office by the Mayor and, thereafter, by the Assembly under Article 20, and holding that office until death, resignation, or removal by the same two bodies acting together.
- (b) No citizen may hold the office of Judge who has not first served among the Officers of Judicial under Section 3, nor may a Judge also hold the office of Mayor, Sheriff, or Head of any other Department while serving.
- (c) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome may hold the office of Judge or be confirmed to it. Any Judge who falls afflicted with the Syndrome during their term shall immediately resign, and the Mayor and Assembly shall jointly confirm a new Judge under Section 1.

Section 2. Rulings Where This Pact Is Silent

Where this Pact is silent on a matter properly brought before it, the Judge shall issue a ruling in writing, stating the matter, the ruling, and the reasoning that led to it, and that ruling shall thereafter bind as though written into this Pact, exactly as Article 1 provides.

- (a) A ruling under this section shall be kept in the Judicial archive and read into the record at the next sitting of the Assembly under Article 20, that no ruling binds the silo in secret.
- (b) A ruling under this section may be overturned only by a later ruling of the Judge on the same matter, or by amendment of this Pact directly under Article 23; it may not be overturned by the Mayor, the Sheriff, or any Head of Department.

Section 3. The Officers of Judicial

Judicial shall keep such Officers as its charge requires, to investigate an offense, to gather what evidence the offense leaves behind, to search where a search is warranted, and to carry out a sentence once given, including the carrying of a citizen to cleaning under Article 18.

- (a) An Officer of Judicial acts always at the direction of the Judge, or, in a matter touching the whole silo's safety, at the implicit command of the Mayor, and never on an Officer's own authority alone.
- (b) The Sheriff and the Officers of Judicial are not the same body. The Sheriff keeps the ordinary peace of the floors under Article 7; the Officers of Judicial act where Judicial itself has found cause to investigate, to search, or to carry out a sentence.
- (c) A search ordered by the Judge for a relic concealed under Article 16 may be made of any floor or room without further condition, save the station of the Sheriff, which may be searched only upon extreme cause found by the Judge, and only after notice of the search is given to the Sheriff beforehand.

Section 4. Judgment and Sentence

Upon an offense investigated under Section 3, the Judge shall determine whether this Pact was broken and, if so, shall set the sentence this Pact provides, without further trial, and that sentence takes effect at once.

- (a) The offender, or the offender's family where the offender cannot be heard, may make representations to the Judge after the sentence is set; the Judge shall hear them, but a representation made under this clause does not delay, lessen, or undo a sentence already taking effect.
- (b) A citizen accused of an offense not among the gravest named under Article 17 may request a hearing before sentence is set, and the Judge shall grant it; this right does not extend to an offense named among the gravest, for which Article 17 and this Article provide their own swiftness. In such a hearing, the accused citizen may speak, may call witnesses to speak to the accused's character or the facts of the offense, and may dispute the Officers' account of what occurred; the Judge shall hear all such evidence before determining guilt and setting sentence.
- (c) Ignorance of this Pact, where it excuses a first offense under Article 17, is weighed by the Judge before any sentence is set, not after.

Section 5. The Archive of Judicial

Judicial shall keep, in its archive, a copy of this Pact, the rolls of citizenship under Article 2, every ruling issued under Section 2, every sentence given under Section 4, and such further record as this Pact elsewhere assigns to its keeping.

- (a) No record kept in the Judicial archive may be altered once entered, save by a further entry noting the correction, the citizen who made it, and the reason given; the original entry shall not be removed.

Article 7

Of the Sheriff and the Keeping of the Peace

In which is set down the charge of the Sheriff: the ordinary peace of the floors, the good order of the stair and every landing upon it, and the keeping of common ground common.

Section 1. The Charge of the Sheriff

The Sheriff is charged with the ordinary peace of the floors, distinct from the Officers of Judicial under Article 6, and holds office Up Top as Article 1 sets down.

- (a) The Sheriff is appointed by the Mayor, who shall weigh the recommendation of the Sheriff then leaving office but is not bound by it, and may appoint to the office any citizen of majority, whether a Deputy of the Sheriff's office or not.
- (b) A Deputy or Peacekeeper of the Sheriff's office serves under the Sheriff in the ordinary conduct of that trade, and remains bound in every other respect to this Pact and to Judicial, exactly as any other citizen is bound.
- (c) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome may hold the office of Sheriff. Any Sheriff who falls afflicted with the Syndrome during their term shall immediately resign, and the Mayor shall appoint a new Sheriff under Section 1.

Section 2. The Stair and the Landings

The stairwell, which Article 1 holds open to every citizen equally, is the Sheriff's particular charge to keep orderly, for it is the one road every citizen must walk, and disorder upon it endangers more than the citizens who make it.

- (a) A citizen ascending the stair keeps to the outer rail, and a citizen descending keeps to the inner rail, that the press of citizens moving in opposite directions not itself become a hazard; the Sheriff may set this practice aside, by posted notice, where a floor's own landing requires it.
- (b) A porter under Article 21, a citizen carrying an urgent word for Judicial or the Sheriff, and a work crew under posted notice under Article 1, pass before any citizen not so charged, and no citizen may impede that passage.
- (c) No citizen may block, occupy, or make camp upon the stair or a landing beyond the ordinary pause for rest, nor raise a hand against another citizen upon it; an offense under this clause, given the height from which a citizen upon the stair may fall, is weighed by the Judge with that danger in mind.
- (d) The Sheriff shall keep a Deputy or Peacekeeper posted at such landings as the press of citizens requires, particularly at the landings nearest the cafeterias, the markets, and the floors of Supply and Mechanical.

Section 3. The Cafeterias and Other Common Areas

The cafeterias, the markets, and every hall where citizens gather beyond their own household are likewise the Sheriff's charge, that gathering not become disorder.

- (a) The Sheriff shall keep such order in a cafeteria, a market under Article 12, or a common hall under Article 20 as the press of citizens requires, and may disperse a gathering that threatens to become disorder, though the Sheriff may not disperse an assembly properly held under Article 20 for the assembly's purpose alone.

- (b) Where a cleaning under Article 18 draws citizens to a cafeteria's wallscreen, the Sheriff shall keep the peace of that gathering, and no citizen may be compelled to attend nor barred from attending, save where the press of citizens itself endangers the floor.
- (c) The freight lift under Article 9, the offices of every Department, and any floor or room this Pact reserves to a particular charge are not common areas under this section, and a citizen found there without leave is answerable under Article 17 as though the citizen had trespassed upon a restricted area.

Section 4. The Keeping of the Peace Between Citizens

The Sheriff shall answer a dispute or a wrong between citizens under Article 17, and shall carry to Judicial any matter the Sheriff cannot resolve by word alone, or any matter Article 17 names among the offenses answered by the mines or among the gravest.

- (a) A citizen may bring a complaint to the Sheriff directly, and the Sheriff shall hear it and act upon it, or refer it to Judicial, within a turn of the season of its bringing.

Section 5. The Trades of the Sheriff's Office

Every trade of the Sheriff's office below the Sheriff's own is entered by the shadowing set down under Article 13; the office of Sheriff itself is not shadowed, and is filled as Section 1 provides.

- (a) The Sheriff then leaving office shall pass to the Mayor, and to whoever succeeds as Sheriff, a full accounting of the floors and landings under Deputy or Peacekeeper charge, and every posted notice given under this Article.

Article 8

Of the Department of Information Technology

In which is set down the charge of the Department of Information Technology: the keeping of the silo's servers and its voice across floors, the licensing of instruments no citizen may make for themselves, and such further duties as this Pact elsewhere leaves to that Department's own instruction.

Section 1. The Charge of Information Technology

The Department of Information Technology is charged with the keeping of the silo's servers, the carrying of word by radio and by wire between floors and offices, the licensing of tools and instruments this Pact elsewhere restricts, and the upkeep of the outward sensors and the wallscreen as Article 1 sets down.

- (a) The Department is led by a Head of Information Technology, and keeps its principal offices in the Mid Thirties, though its charge under this Article extends to every floor.
- (b) Every citizen assigned to a trade of Information Technology serves under the Head of Information Technology in the ordinary conduct of that trade, and remains bound in every other respect to this Pact, to the Sheriff, and to Judicial, exactly as any other citizen is bound.
- (c) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome may hold the office of Head of Information Technology. Any Head of Information Technology

who falls afflicted with the Syndrome during their tenure shall immediately resign, and the Mayor shall confirm a new Head under the shadowing process set down in Article 13.

Section 2. The Licensing of Dangerous Instruments

No citizen may make, keep, or use any lens or glass that magnifies beyond the ordinary power of reading spectacles, any device that sends or receives word without a wire strung and licensed for the purpose, or any fine instrument for the working of metal, wire, or glass, save under a license issued by Information Technology.

- (a) A license issued under this section shall name the citizen, the tool, and the floor of its use, and shall be entered in a roll kept by Information Technology and shared with Judicial, that the two rolls may be reconciled one against the other at any time either Department requires.
- (b) A tool or device of the kind named in this section, found in the keeping of a citizen without license, is a relic forbidden under Article 16, whatever use the citizen claims to have intended for it, and its finding shall be reported to Judicial without delay.
- (c) Information Technology shall license to Mechanical such tools as Article 9 requires for its own work, under the same manner of numbering, recording, and return set down there.

Section 3. Radios and the Silo's Word

No wire, radio, or like device for the carrying of word beyond the reach of a citizen's own voice may be built, strung, or operated save by Information Technology or under its license, and no citizen may carry word by such means on another citizen's behalf without that license.

- (a) Word that must travel between floors, and is not licensed to pass by wire or radio, shall be carried by a porter under Article 21.
- (b) Information Technology shall keep such stations for the carrying of official word between the Mayor, the Sheriff, Judicial, and the Heads of every Department as the silo's business requires, and no citizen not assigned to that keeping may make use of them.

Section 4. The Sensors, the Wallscreen, and the Record of the Dead

The upkeep, cleaning, and repair of the outward sensors and the wallscreen is the charge of Information Technology under Article 1, exercised under such further procedure as this Pact does not set down, that procedure being no part of ordinary citizenship.

- (a) Where a citizen is sent to cleaning under Article 18, the word of Information Technology that the sensors were kept is sufficient, under Article 2, for Judicial to close that citizen's name in the rolls, and no further attestation is required.
- (b) The suit worn by a citizen sent to clean is assembled in the cleaning lab under this charge, to a specification Information Technology alone sets and is instructed in, from cloth, seals, and fittings furnished by Mechanical and Supply, as Article 18 sets down.

Section 5. Relics of Craft and Contrivance

A relic of craft or contrivance from before the silo's sealing, surrendered under Article 16 or found by Judicial, shall be delivered to Information Technology for examination, that its danger may be judged by those fitted to judge it.

- (a) Information Technology shall report to Judicial what a relic examined under this section is and what became of it, but need not report how it was examined, nor keep the relic for any citizen's later viewing.

Section 6. The Trades of Information Technology

Every trade of Information Technology is entered by the shadowing set down under Article 13.

- (a) The Head of Information Technology names a successor from among the Department's own trades, and that naming stands as though confirmed, unless the Mayor and Judicial jointly object within one turn of the season.

Article 9

Of the Department of Mechanical

In which is set down the charge of the Department of Mechanical: the generator, the works of water and air, the reclamation of what is worn, and the narrow road — the freight lift, and no other — by which goods may pass where citizens may not.

Section 1. The Charge of Mechanical

The Department of Mechanical is charged with the keeping of the generator, the works of water and air, the reclamation of the silo's worn substance, and the structural soundness of the shaft itself, so far as such soundness may be tended without opening any passage forbidden under Article 1.

- (a) The Department is led by a Head of Mechanical, raised up from among its own trades by the shadowing entered into under Article 13, and confirmed in office by the Mayor.
- (b) Every citizen assigned to a trade of Mechanical serves under the Head of Mechanical in the ordinary conduct of that trade, though such a citizen remains bound in every other respect to this Pact, to the Sheriff, and to Judicial exactly as any other citizen is bound.
- (c) The Head of Mechanical shall reside and keep the Department's offices in the Down Deep, among the works described in this Article, and not Up Top.

Section 2. Power, Circulation, and Reclamation

The generator that gives the silo its light and its warmth, the works that draw water fit to drink from water fouled, the vents and scrubbers that keep the silo's air breathable, and the reclamation of cloth, metal, and matter too worn for its first purpose are here treated as one charge, for the failure of any one of them, left untended, threatens all the rest.

- (a) The generator, its housing, and every line and switch that carries its power beyond that housing are the sole charge of Mechanical. No citizen not assigned to that charge may open, adjust, or attempt repair of any part of it.
- (b) The works of water and air — the treatment of water drawn from below, the scrubbing and venting of the silo's air, and the lines that carry both beyond the Down Deep — are likewise the sole charge of Mechanical, exercised alongside Supply where Supply's own stores of water and air are concerned, under Article 11.
- (c) Mechanical shall reclaim, so far as reclamation is possible, the cloth, metal, plastic, and other matter surrendered by citizens or gathered by Supply and Judicial, returning to use what can be made fit for it, and recording, but not destroying without instruction, what cannot.
- (d) Interference with any part of the generator, the works of water and air, or the labor of reclamation is treated, without exception, as among the gravest offenses under Article 17.

Section 3. The Freight Lift

The one exception named under Article 1 to the silo's single stair is the freight lift running between the Down Deep and the floors of Supply, built and kept by Mechanical for the carrying of goods too heavy or too many for a citizen's own back.

- (a) The freight lift carries goods only. No citizen may ride within it, and no citizen may request or be granted passage within it, save a Mechanical or Supply worker in the direct performance of loading, unloading, or the lift's own repair.
- (b) Every use of the freight lift shall be logged — the goods carried, the citizen who ordered the carrying, and the floors between which it ran — and kept in the records of Mechanical under Article 21.

- (c) The freight lift shall be run at no greater speed, and shall draw no greater share of the generator's power, than the Head of Mechanical judges the generator can bear without want to any other citizen's need for light, warmth, or water.
- (d) The making of any device to carry a citizen's own body between floors, whatever its design and whoever proposes it, is forbidden under Article 16.

Section 4. Structural Work and the Prohibition Against Digging

Article 1 forbids any citizen to dig, bore, blast, or otherwise open a passage not already given by the silo's builders, save under the direct order of the Head of Mechanical and the joint knowledge of the Mayor. This section sets down how such an order is given and kept.

- (a) An order under this section may be given only in writing, signed by the Head of Mechanical and countersigned by the Mayor, naming the floor, the wall or ceiling to be opened, the reason for the work, and the citizens who will perform it.
- (b) No such order may be given for the opening of any passage between the silo and the world above, nor for any depth beyond what the builders themselves reached, regardless of the reason offered or the office of the one offering it.
- (c) A copy of every order given under this section shall be kept in the records of Mechanical and in the Judicial archive.
- (d) No passage opened under this section may be used for any purpose beyond the work named in the order, and shall be closed and made sound again upon that work's completion, to the satisfaction of the Head of Mechanical, before any citizen but a Mechanical worker may pass it again.

Section 5. Tools, Materials, and Their Licensing

Mechanical's work requires tools and instruments that this Pact elsewhere restricts to every other citizen, among them glasses and lenses beyond the

ordinary power forbidden under Article 16, and fine instruments for the working of metal and wire.

- (a) The Department of Information Technology shall license to Mechanical such tools as its work requires, each tool numbered, its whereabouts recorded, and its return confirmed upon the completion of the work for which it was drawn.
- (b) No tool licensed under this section may be carried beyond the floor of its use without the leave of the Head of Mechanical, nor kept by any citizen beyond the day of its return, nor lent, sold, or given to any citizen not licensed under this section in their own right.
- (c) A citizen found to hold, or to have made, any tool of the kind licensed under this section without such license is treated exactly as though the tool were a relic forbidden under Article 16, whatever use the citizen claims to have intended for it.

Section 6. The Trades of the Down Deep

Every trade of Mechanical — the tending of the generator, the working of water and air, the reclamation of matter, and the keeping of the silo's structure — is entered as every other trade is entered, by the shadowing set down under Article 13, save that no citizen may shadow into the tending of the generator, the licensing of tools under this Article, or the ordering of work under Section 4 without also being found fit by the Head of Mechanical, beyond whatever fitness Article 13 alone would require.

- (a) The Head of Mechanical shall keep, and pass to their own shadow before leaving office, a full accounting of the Department's tools, its licensed citizens, and its outstanding orders under this Article.
- (b) No citizen shall be assigned to Mechanical against the citizen's own naming of a trade at the age Article 13 sets down, save where the Department's need for a given trade cannot otherwise be met, in which case Judicial shall confirm that the assignment is not made in punishment.

Section 7. Critical Infrastructure and Hidden Systems

Mechanical maintains certain systems and installations that are critical to the silo's survival but whose location, design, or operation must be

kept from ordinary citizen knowledge, that the integrity of such systems be preserved and that citizens not be moved to interfere with or rely upon them improperly.

- (a) The Head of Mechanical shall maintain a complete accounting, kept in a secured record in the Judicial archive, of all critical infrastructure installed below the builder's own deepest works, including but not limited to: intake and drainage systems, bypass conduits, and contingency passages. The location of such systems shall not be disclosed to any citizen not assigned directly to its maintenance and operation.
- (b) A citizen who discovers the location or existence of such a system, and reveals that location or existence to any other citizen, shall report the matter immediately to the Head of Mechanical and to Judicial, and may not discuss or describe the system to any other citizen, upon penalty of Article 17.
- (c) A citizen who attempts to locate, map, or gain access to such systems without authorization from the Head of Mechanical, or who tampers with any such system, is answerable under Article 17 as for endangering the silo's structural integrity or essential systems.
- (d) The Head of Mechanical is accountable to the Mayor and to Judicial for all such systems, and shall provide a report on their condition once yearly, in private audience, to both offices. No such system shall be altered, opened, or modified save by order of the Head of Mechanical with the Mayor's joint knowledge.
- (e) Where the Mayor's ordinary decisions might affect a given critical infrastructure system, the Head of Mechanical may inform the Mayor of the system's existence, location, and nature, and shall bind the Mayor to secrecy under the same restriction that applies to Mechanical's own workers. Whether the Mayor is informed of a particular critical system is the sole determination of the Head of Mechanical.

Article 10

Of the Department of Mines

In which is set down the charge of the Department of Mines: the winning of ore from the depths below the silo, the limits set upon the miners' working, and the oversight of the silo's ore supply for the working of metal and the silo's own repair.

Section 1. The Charge of Mines

The Department of Mines is charged with the winning of ore from the workings below the Down Deep, that the silo may have metal for its own working and repair, and that the silo's reserves of ore may never fall below such quantity as the Head of Mines judges necessary for the silo's keeping.

- (a) The Department is led by a Head of Mines, raised up from among its own trades by the shadowing entered into under Article 13, and confirmed in office by the Mayor.
- (b) Every citizen assigned to a trade of Mines serves under the Head of Mines in the ordinary conduct of that trade, though such a citizen remains bound in every other respect to this Pact, to the Sheriff, and to Judicial exactly as any other citizen is bound.
- (c) The Head of Mines shall reside and keep the Department's offices in the Down Deep, among the workings described in this Article, and not Up Top.

Section 2. The Winning of Ore

The removal and processing of ore from the silo's depths is a labor of great weight, requiring strength of body, steadiness of nerve, and intimate knowledge of the workings' structure and history. This section sets down the scope and method of the Department's charge.

- (a) The winning of ore in the workings below the Down Deep is a standing charge of Mines and needs no order under Article 9 for its ordinary continuation.
- (b) Every citizen assigned to the winning of ore works under the direct supervision of a miner of proven skill, and no citizen may work alone in any working, regardless of experience or office.
- (c) The ore won shall be brought to the processing stations under the charge of Mines, where it is measured, recorded, and delivered to the Department of Mechanical for the working of metal and the silo's repair under Article 9.
- (d) No citizen not assigned to Mines may enter any working or remove any ore or stone from below the Down Deep save under direct written order of the Head of Mines, countersigned by the Mayor, for a purpose set down in that order.

Section 3. The Two-Hundred-Foot Radius

The founders, in their engineering of the silo, set a limit upon how far the miners might work outward from the silo's own structure. This limit stands as their judgment and is not to be questioned or exceeded.

- (a) No working of ore may run, in any direction, beyond two hundred feet from the silo's own structure, for cause the builders judged sufficient and did not set down.
- (b) Any citizen who works ore, or directs the working of ore, beyond this limit is treated as among the gravest offenses under Article 17, without regard to ignorance of the limit or the purpose of the work.
- (c) The Head of Mines is charged with knowing the silo's structure and the distance it is, and with ensuring that no working extends beyond the limit. A citizen assigned to Mines who believes a working has been carried, or is being carried, beyond the limit may report the matter directly to Judicial, without first carrying it to the Head of

Mines, and Judicial shall inquire of the Head of Mines and rule upon the working's lawfulness.

Section 4. Coordination with Mechanical and Judicial

The Department of Mines works in the Down Deep alongside the Department of Mechanical, and both must keep the other informed of the work being done, that neither undermines the silo's structure or the other's safety.

- (a) The Head of Mines and the Head of Mechanical shall meet no fewer than once per ten days to discuss the workings being opened, the shoring being done, and the state of the structures shared between Mechanical and Mines.
- (b) Where a working threatens the integrity of the silo's structure or the water lines, the generator's housing, or any other charge of Mechanical, the Head of Mechanical may order the working halted until the threat is resolved, and may carry that order to Judicial if the Head of Mines refuses to comply.
- (c) Where a citizen assigned to Mines is suspected of taking ore beyond the two-hundred-foot limit, or of deliberate failure to measure the distance, Judicial shall investigate and make a finding under Article 6 before any punishment is carried out.

Section 5. The Trades of Mines

Every trade of Mines — the breaking and removal of ore, the processing and measuring of ore, the shoring and tending of workings, and the keeping of records and accounting — is entered as every other trade is entered, by the shadowing set down under Article 13, save that no citizen may shadow into the breaking of ore or the measuring of distance without also being found fit by the Head of Mines, beyond whatever fitness Article 13 alone would require.

- (a) The Head of Mines shall keep, and pass to their own shadow before leaving office, a full accounting of the ore won by season, the workings that have been opened and closed, and the distances measured from the silo's structure to the farthest working.

- (b) No citizen shall be assigned to Mines against the citizen's own naming of a trade at the age Article 13 sets down, save where the Department's need for a given trade cannot otherwise be met, in which case Judicial shall confirm that the assignment is not made in punishment.

Article 11

Of Supply, Hydroponics, and the Ration

In which is set down the charge of Supply: the growing of food, the keeping of its stores and the silo's stores of water and air, and the setting of the ration by which every citizen's share is known and kept fair.

Section 1. The Charge of Supply

Supply is charged with the growing of food, the keeping of the silo's stores of food, water, and air, and the setting and distribution of the ration by which those stores are shared among the citizens.

- (a) The Department is led by a Head of Supply, raised up from among its own trades by the shadowing entered into under Article 13, and confirmed in office by the Mayor.
- (b) Every citizen assigned to a trade of Supply serves under the Head of Supply in the ordinary conduct of that trade, and remains bound in every other respect to this Pact, to the Sheriff, and to Judicial, exactly as any other citizen is bound.

Section 2. Hydroponics and the Keeping of Livestock

The growing of food is carried out in the hydroponic farms of the Mids, as Article 1 sets down, and in such further plots and pens as Supply is

given charge of.

- (a) Supply may keep livestock for the ration's sake, in such number and kind as the silo's stores of feed and space allow, and no citizen not assigned to that keeping may tend, slaughter, or dispose of an animal kept under this clause.
- (b) A citizen who tends the farms or the livestock of Supply is answerable for the yield of that tending, and a citizen found to have wasted, spoiled, or diverted food or feed from its proper use is answerable under Article 17.

Section 3. The Ration

The ration is set by the Head of Supply from the full count of the rolls under Article 2, and no other number, that every citizen's share may be known and kept fair.

- (a) A citizen's ration is theirs by right from naming to death, save where this Pact provides otherwise, and is not increased for labor, office, or seniority, though it may be adjusted for age, health, or condition where Article 13 or Article 19 expressly provides.
- (b) Where the silo's stores fall short of the ration this Pact provides, the Head of Supply shall report the shortfall to the Mayor and to Judicial without delay, and the ration shall be lessened by the smallest measure the shortfall requires, and lessened alike for every citizen, without exception of floor, trade, or office.
- (c) Goods too many or too heavy for a citizen's own carrying shall pass between the Down Deep and the floors of Supply by the freight lift under Article 9, and from Supply to every floor by such further means as this Pact elsewhere provides.

Section 4. Stores of Water and Air

Supply shall keep such stores of water and air as Mechanical delivers under Article 9, and shall distribute them by the same ration this Article sets down.

- (a) Where the works of water or air under Article 9 fail or fall short, Supply shall draw upon its stores to hold the ration steady for so long as those stores allow, and shall report to the Head of Mechanical and to the Mayor the day those stores will not.

Section 5. Sanctioned Animals Kept by Citizens

A citizen who wishes to keep an animal for companionship, and not for the ration, may petition Supply to sanction it; Supply shall weigh the silo's stores of feed against the asking, and may grant, limit, or refuse the sanction as those stores require.

- (a) An animal kept under this section draws upon the household's own ration for its feed, and is counted, for every purpose of this Pact, as the sanctioning citizen's to answer for.
- (b) An animal kept without sanction under this section is treated as livestock diverted from Supply under Section 2, and the citizen keeping it is answerable under Article 17.

Article 12

Of Trade, Chits, and Commerce

In which is set down the chit, the silo's currency of trade, the marketplace where citizens buy and sell goods beyond the ration, and the keeping of accounts that make such commerce orderly and just.

Section 1. The Chit and the Earning of Chits

A chit is a token of value, issued by the silo and verified by the Chit-Keepers under Section 3, that represents a citizen's claim upon the silo's goods and the skilled labor of other citizens. A citizen earns chits through labor—by the work done in a trade, by the goods made or services rendered, by the time spent in the silo's keeping or the Departments' employ.

- (a) Every citizen engaged in labor under Article 13 shall receive chits as payment for that labor, at a rate set by the Heads of Departments in consultation with the Mayor. The rate may vary by trade—skilled labor receives more than unskilled, dangerous labor may receive more than safe—but no citizen's chits shall be withheld or docked as punishment for work performed, save as Article 16 or 17 provides.
- (b) A citizen retired from labor under Article 13 shall continue to receive a modest sustenance in chits, sufficient to purchase small goods and comforts beyond the ration, administered by Supply under Article 11 upon the Infirmary's certification of the citizen's continuing need under Article 19.

- (c) A citizen sentenced to the mines under Article 17 receives no chits during the sentence; upon release, chits resume at the rate set for the citizen's assigned trade.
- (d) Chits are personal property and may not be seized, stolen, or diverted, save by Judicial order for the payment of debts or damages under Article 17. A citizen robbed of chits may appeal to the Sheriff for recovery; a citizen unable to recover them may petition Judicial for recompense.

Section 2. The Marketplace and the Sale of Goods

Beyond the guaranteed ration of Article 11, citizens may purchase additional goods, specialized items, and the skilled labor of other citizens using chits. The marketplace is the ordinary mechanism of this trade: citizens may sell goods they have made or grown, or labor they have performed, to other citizens, with chits passing between them.

- (a) A citizen may buy and sell goods with other citizens without restriction, save that no citizen may sell goods that belong to the silo or to a Department — a Mechanical worker may not sell the silo's tools, nor a Supply clerk the silo's stores, and so for every Department alike.
- (b) A citizen engaged in a skilled trade—tailoring, cobbling, carpentry, or other craft—may sell the fruits of that trade to other citizens for chits, in addition to any goods the citizen's Department provides.
- (c) The silo maintains markets—designated areas on floors throughout the silo—where citizens may gather to buy and sell. The Sheriff under Article 7 keeps order in the markets and ensures no violence or theft occurs there.
- (d) A Market Clerk, raised up by short shadowing under Article 13 and appointed by the Mayor or the relevant Department Head, oversees a market and may set aside stalls for regular vendors or open vendors, may establish basic rules of conduct against spoiled goods and fraudulent claims, and may report disputes to Judicial or the Sheriff as required.

Section 3. The Chit-Keepers and the Regulation of Currency

Chits are issued by the silo through the Chit-Keepers, who maintain the accounts of every citizen, verify the authenticity of chits in circulation, prevent counterfeiting, and ensure that the silo's currency holds its value and remains trustworthy.

- (a) The Chit-Keepers are appointed by the Mayor and overseen by the Head of Supply under Article 11. The Chit-Keepers keep two rolls: one master roll of all chits issued, and one ledger of every citizen's balance, debits, and credits.
- (b) A citizen may, at any time, ask a Chit-Keeper to audit the citizen's balance or the authenticity of chits the citizen holds. The Chit-Keeper shall verify the chits and compare them to the citizen's ledger entry; any discrepancy is reported to Judicial.
- (c) Counterfeiting a chit, or possessing a counterfeit chit knowing it to be false, is among the gravest offenses under Article 17, as it strikes at the silo's foundation of trust in its own currency.
- (d) The Chit-Keepers may, at the Mayor's direction, revalue chits in the event of severe shortage or glut — as, for example, where the silo's stores are depleted and chits have grown too numerous, the Mayor may order a revaluation downward. Such a revaluation is announced to the Assembly under Article 20 and entered in the Judicial archive.

Section 4. Prices, Fairness, and the Regulation of Commerce

The silo does not fix the price of goods sold between citizens; a tailor and a customer may negotiate what chits a shirt is worth. But the silo does intervene where prices become extortionate or where a citizen attempts to monopolize a necessary good.

- (a) A citizen may charge what price they wish for goods or labor offered to another citizen, and the other citizen may refuse to pay. No one is compelled to buy or sell at any given price.
- (b) If a citizen accuses another of charging an unjust price—unreasonably high compared to the goods' actual value or necessity—either party

may appeal to the Market Clerk in the first instance; if either party remains unsatisfied, the matter is carried to Judicial, which alone may rule that the price is unjust and order a transaction reversed or the chits returned.

- (c) A citizen may not charge a price so high that other citizens are priced out of necessary goods — as, for example, a water-seal seller charging so much that ordinary citizens cannot afford to seal their household water-stores. In such case the Mayor may, under the emergency authority of Article 22, set a maximum price for goods deemed essential; this is a measure of general policy reserved for genuine emergency, and is no substitute for Judicial's ordinary adjudication of a single unjust transaction under the clause above.
- (d) No citizen may prevent another citizen from selling goods or labor in the marketplace, save where Judicial finds the person selling is engaged in fraud, theft, or the sale of forbidden items under Article 16.

Section 5. Debt, Credit, and the Settling of Accounts

A citizen may borrow chits from another citizen, creating a debt that must be repaid. The silo does not compel repayment of such debts, but the Chit-Keepers keep records of them, and Judicial may enforce them if a debtor refuses to pay and the creditor brings suit.

- (a) A debt is a promise of repayment made between two citizens, recorded either by their own sworn statement to the Chit-Keepers or by a written note signed by both parties. A debt so recorded is legally binding.
- (b) A debtor who is unable to repay may petition Judicial for a reduction of the debt or an extended payment schedule; Judicial may grant such relief if the debtor's circumstances are genuine and the creditor is not unduly harmed.
- (c) A creditor who forgives a debt shall notify the Chit-Keepers, and the debt is removed from the ledger. A creditor who refuses to record the forgiveness, continuing to claim a debt the citizen has actually repaid, is answerable under Article 17 for fraud.

- (d) Enslavement to debt—a citizen being held to infinite servitude to pay a debt—is forbidden. No debt shall extend beyond the debtor’s death, nor shall a debt be transferred to a debtor’s children or heirs.

Section 6. The Goods and Services of the Silo

The silo’s skilled workers—tailors, cobblers, carpenters, rope-makers, and others—may be engaged for work by citizens willing to pay chits. The silo does not compel such work; the craftspeople may accept or refuse commissions as they choose.

- (a) A skilled worker may, in addition to any work performed for their Department, undertake private commissions from citizens willing to pay chits. The worker and the citizen shall agree on a price and timeline before the work begins.
- (b) A citizen commissioned to make a good may refuse the commission without penalty, and a citizen commissioning a good may refuse to accept it or pay if the work is not as promised; disputes over such commissions are heard by the Market Clerk in the first instance, and, if either party remains unsatisfied, by Judicial.
- (c) Certain goods and services are restricted to licensed or skilled workers only — as, for example, only a physician may sell medicines under Article 19, and only an electrician may repair certain technical goods under Article 8’s licensing. A citizen advertising such goods or services without proper license is answerable under Article 17.

Section 7. The Protection of the Marketplace and the Silo’s Trust

The marketplace depends on trust: that chits are real, that sellers deliver what they promise, that buyers pay fairly, and that the Sheriff and the Chit-Keepers enforce these expectations. The protection of this trust is a standing charge of the Sheriff’s office and the Chit-Keepers themselves.

- (a) The Sheriff patrols the markets and nearby areas where citizens gather to trade, and may apprehend any citizen observed committing theft, fraud, or violence in the course of trade.
- (b) A citizen who is defrauded in a trade—sold counterfeit goods, shorted on chits, or given lesser work than promised—may report the mat-

ter to the Sheriff or the Market Clerk; that official shall investigate and, if fraud is found, refer the fraudster to Judicial.

- (c) The Chit-Keepers maintain security over the silo's stores of blank chits and the apparatus by which new chits are issued; any citizen who steals or tampers with blank chits, or who aids in their theft or counterfeiting, is answerable under Article 17 among the gravest offenses.

Article 13

Of Labor, Shadowing, and the Assignment

In which is set down how the silo's citizens are matched to their work, how they are taught to do it, and the principle by which some labor is chosen freely and some is assigned by need.

Section 1. The Charge of Labor and the Principle of Assignment

Every citizen, from the sixteenth naming-day onward, is bound to contribute labor to the silo's keeping, in such a trade or profession as the citizen's own aptitude, the silo's needs, and the Pact's requirements together determine. The silo contains one hundred and forty-four levels, built and provisioned to hold many thousands of souls; the work required to keep so many fed, watered, warmed, aired, and sheltered is immense and various. No citizen's labor is purchased by chits or offered freely; it is owed to the silo itself as a debt of citizenship.

- (a) A citizen may petition to enter a trade or profession for which the citizen has aptitude and desire, and such petition shall not be refused save where the silo's need for that trade is already met and other work goes short. The silo's welfare takes precedence over the individual citizen's preference, but a citizen's own petition is weighed first.
- (b) Where a trade is in short supply and the silo's need is critical,

the Mayor and the Head of the relevant Department may jointly assign a citizen to that trade, without the citizen's consent, provided Judicial confirms that the assignment is not made in punishment under Article 17.

- (c) A citizen assigned to a trade without consent shall be tested for fitness in that trade; a citizen found unfit may petition Judicial for reassignment, and Judicial's finding shall bind.
- (d) A citizen who neglects the labor assigned, or who diverts the silo's tools, materials, or the citizen's own owed labor-time to a private study, pursuit, or fixation of the citizen's own devising, wastes what the silo cannot spare. The Head of the citizen's Department shall first correct such neglect by closer oversight or reassignment to labor better suited to occupy the citizen fully; where the neglect persists notwithstanding, the Head shall refer the matter to Judicial.

Section 2. The Testing of Aptitude

From a citizen's twelfth naming-day forward, the schools under Article 15 shall assess each child's aptitude for various kinds of labor: the working of tools, the tending of living things, the care of people, the working with numbers, the keeping of records, and such other aptitudes as the silo's work requires. A citizen reaching majority shall have some knowledge of which trades might suit the citizen's own nature.

- (a) The testing of aptitude is not a trial to be passed or failed; it is a guidance, carried into the citizen's majority and weighed when the citizen first petitions for entry into a trade.
- (b) A citizen may petition to enter a trade notwithstanding the aptitude testing's results, but a Head of a Department may weigh the results against the petition: where a citizen's expressed desire runs sharply against demonstrated aptitude, the Head may require an extended trial period or additional testing before accepting the citizen's shadow.
- (c) A citizen who petitions for a trade for which the silo has no current need, but for which the citizen has clear aptitude, may be placed on a waiting list; if the silo's need for that trade grows, the waiting citizen has first claim when a shadow becomes available.

Section 3. The Three Tiers of Shadowing and Labor Entry

The silo's work is divided into three categories by the length and rigor of training required. A citizen enters a trade through one of three pathways: a full shadowing of years spent learning from a departing master; a short shadowing of weeks or months for moderately skilled labor; or direct assignment to a simple task requiring little or no formal training.

- (a) Full shadowing is the entry into trades of high skill, significant responsibility, or access to restricted knowledge or dangerous instruments. The shadowing shall not be less than three years nor more than seven, at the sole determination of the master being shadowed; the shadow shall live and work alongside the master, learning not only the technical work but the judgment and reliability the trade requires.
- (b) Short shadowing is the entry into trades of moderate skill or administrative responsibility. The shadowing shall be no fewer than four weeks and ordinarily no longer than one season, or two seasons in exceptional cases, at the determination of the master or the Head of the Department.
- (c) Direct assignment without formal shadowing is permitted for labor of little skill requirement, such as simple carrying, sorting, distribution, or maintenance tasks. A citizen assigned to such work receives instruction as the work requires, but no formal apprenticeship period.
- (d) A citizen who has shadowed under a master may not be removed from that shadow by the citizen's own request, nor by the master's, save with the consent of the other party or a finding by Judicial that the shadow is unfit. A shadow abandoned by either party without cause is answerable under Article 17 for breach of a commitment made before Judicial.

Section 4. Mundane Labor and the Simple Tra

The silo requires much work of simple character: the carrying of goods and messages, the distribution of supplies, the painting and repair of common surfaces, the sorting of salvage, the cleaning of common areas, the tending of the simple tasks of kitchen and cafeteria. These trades

require no formal shadowing, little specialized training, and are open to any citizen of sufficient strength or steadiness for the work.

- (a) A citizen wishing to enter such work may do so upon the petition to the relevant Head of Department or, for work not assigned to any Department, to the Mayor. The Head shall assign the citizen to the work or place the citizen on a list of those available.
- (b) No license, restricted access, or formal testing is required for such work, save that a citizen assigned to the keeping or moving of the silo's stored goods shall be spot-checked for honesty by periodic audits of what is carried and what is delivered.
- (c) A citizen engaged in simple labor may be reassigned by the Head of the Department at will, with one cycle of ten days' notice.

Section 5. Skilled Trades and Full Shadowing

The silo's vital functions depend on trades of genuine skill: the tending of the generator and the works of water and air, the working of metal and the repair of machinery, the keeping of food stocks and the growing of crops, the healing of the sick, the keeping of records, the investigation of crime and the carrying out of sentences, the teaching of the young. These trades require years of learning under a master and may not be entered save through full shadowing.

- (a) A citizen wishing to enter a skilled trade shall petition the Head of the relevant Department. The Head shall examine the citizen's aptitude testing and interview the citizen, and may accept or refuse the petition. A refusal may be appealed to Judicial.
- (b) Where a shadow is accepted, a master who possesses the trade and plans to step down from it shall take the shadow as an apprentice. A master who does not plan to step down may be required by the Head of Department to take a shadow if the Department's needs require it, provided Judicial finds the requirement just.
- (c) The shadow shall be tested, formally and informally, throughout the shadowing period. A shadow found unfit may be dismissed by the master or the Head of Department, provided Judicial is informed; a shadow dismissed may petition Judicial for reassignment to a different trade.

- (d) Upon the completion of shadowing, the master shall attest the citizen's readiness to the Head of Department. The Head shall confirm the citizen in the trade, or, if the Head finds the citizen unfit despite the master's attestation, shall refer the matter to Judicial for a ruling.

Section 6. Critical Roles and Order-Adjacent Trades

Certain trades carry access to knowledge or authority that goes beyond the ordinary silo's work: the technicians of Information Technology, the Sensor and Wallscreen workers, the Cleaning-Lab technicians, the teachers of the young, the Officers of Judicial, the Physicians of the Infirmary. These roles require not only full shadowing but additional testing and vetting, beyond what the shadowing system alone determines.

- (a) A citizen entering a critical role shall undergo, in addition to the usual shadowing, such further testing and vetting as the relevant Head of Department determines. This vetting may include examination by Judicial, investigation by the Officers of Judicial, and assessment of the citizen's steadiness, discretion, and loyalty to the Pact.
- (b) No citizen shall be compelled to undergo such vetting, and a citizen refusing it shall not be forced into a critical role; a citizen may withdraw from a shadow for a critical role at any point, and shall not be punished for the withdrawal.
- (c) A citizen confirmed in a critical role remains subject to this vetting throughout the citizen's tenure; a Head of Department may require additional vetting at any time, and may remove a citizen from a critical role if the vetting reveals cause.
- (d) The specifics of the vetting for any particular critical role are not set down in this Pact, but are determined by the Head of Department and are kept in the Judicial archive. No vetting procedure may contradict this Pact or require a citizen to violate it.
- (e) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome may enter, hold, or continue in any critical role, nor may any citizen afflicted with the Syndrome be confirmed as a Head of Department. Any citizen confirmed in such a role who falls afflicted with the Syndrome shall immediately

report the affliction and resign from the role, and the relevant Department or the Mayor shall proceed with the shadowing and vetting process to confirm a successor.

Section 7. The Management of Labor Supply and Citizen Assignment

The silo's various Departments require different numbers of citizens in different trades, and these needs change as the silo ages, as citizens retire or are removed by death or cleaning, and as the work itself changes. Where the silo's need for a particular trade cannot be met by citizens' own petitions, the system of assignment ensures adequate staffing.

- (a) Each Head of Department shall, annually or as the Department's needs change, report to the Mayor the Department's required staffing levels by trade. The Mayor, in consultation with the Heads of Department and the Assembly under Article 20, shall establish the silo's labor needs for the coming year.
- (b) Where citizens' own petitions for a trade exceed the silo's need for that trade, the excess petitioners are placed on waiting lists by their petition date; as citizens retire or die, the waiting list is filled in order.
- (c) Where the silo's need for a trade exceeds the number of citizens who have petitioned for it, and waiting lists are exhausted, the Mayor and the relevant Head of Department may jointly assign citizens to that trade, subject to Judicial confirmation as provided in Section 1.
- (d) No citizen of majority shall be left without assignment to some trade or labor, and no citizen's trade shall be left vacant without a shadow being prepared to fill it, save in genuine emergency. A citizen unable to find a trade to petition shall be assigned to mundane labor by the Mayor, pending opportunity for training in a more specialized field.

Section 8. Reassignment, Retirement, and the Management of Change

A citizen's first assigned trade is not permanent. Citizens may petition for reassignment to a different trade after a minimum period of service

(five years for skilled trades, one year for simple labor); citizens may be reassigned by their Department if the citizen's fitness is questioned or the silo's needs change; citizens may retire from labor upon reaching such age as the Infirmary and the Mayor jointly determine.

- (a) A citizen petitioning for reassignment to a different trade shall undergo the usual petition and shadowing process for the new trade, except that a citizen's prior aptitude testing may be waived by the Head of the new Department if the citizen's years of successful service in another skilled trade demonstrate the necessary aptitude.
- (b) A citizen removed from a trade for cause (unfitness, abandonment of the shadowing, or breach of the citizen's duties) may petition for reassignment to a different trade, and Judicial shall rule on the petition; Judicial may grant reassignment, deny it, or require a period of service in mundane labor before permitting a reassignment to a new skilled trade.
- (c) A citizen reaching such age as the Infirmary judges the citizen no longer fit for the citizen's current trade may be reassigned to simpler labor, or, if unfit for any labor, may petition for retirement. Retirement ends the citizen's labor obligation under this Article, and the citizen becomes the responsibility of the silo under Article 19.
- (d) Where a Department's need for a particular trade diminishes, and the citizens holding that trade cannot be reassigned within the Department, they shall be reassigned to other Departments' needs, or retrained for related work, or retired if age or fitness permits. No citizen shall be removed from employment without alternative assignment or retirement.

Section 9. The Rights and Duties of the Shadowed

A citizen in shadowing is in a status between ordinary citizenship and full membership in a trade. The shadow owes the master and the silo earnest labor and obedience to the master's teaching; the master, the Department, and the silo owe the shadow fair treatment, protection from harm, and assessment according to genuine fitness.

- (a) A shadow shall receive the same ration as any other citizen under Article 11, and shall not be docked for tools, materials, or lodging

during the shadowing period, save where the shadow has been assigned to lodging within the Department's own quarters, as a Down Deep trade requiring residence in Mechanical's own space.

- (b) A shadow may not be punished by the master for ordinary mistakes in learning, but may be dismissed for willful negligence, refusal to obey instruction, or breach of the Pact. A shadow dismissed shall be paid for the time worked and shall not be bound by any contract to repay training costs.
- (c) A master may not strike, deprive of food, or otherwise assault a shadow, and a shadow subjected to such treatment may appeal to Judicial or the Sheriff under Article 7 for relief and may be released from the shadowing without penalty.

Article 14

Of Housing and the Floors

In which is set down the keeping of living quarters for every citizen, the assignment of floors by the silo's zones, the accountability of citizens for their dwelling places, and the principle that every citizen shall have shelter and no citizen shall have more than is needful.

Section 1. The Charge of Housing and the Distribution of Quarters

Every citizen is entitled to a dwelling place appropriate to the citizen's household size and the silo's available stores, held under the administration of the Department of Supply under Article 11. No citizen may claim a dwelling as permanent property, nor may any citizen occupy a floor or dwelling without the approval and assignment of the Head of Supply, and no assignment may be moved or changed without the same approval given in good faith.

- (a) A dwelling shall be assigned to a citizen household by size and need: a single citizen, an aged citizen living alone, or a child too young for independent keeping shall receive a single room or small quarters; a partnership of two citizens contracted under Article 3 shall receive quarters adequate to the partnership's needs; a parent with one or more children shall receive quarters adequate to the household, with additional space for each child born under the lottery of Article 3.

- (b) A citizen assigned to a dwelling may make reasonable modifications to the interior (paint, arrangement of common furnishings, minor repairs), provided the citizen restores the dwelling to its original condition upon leaving or ceding the assignment; major structural repairs shall be made only by the Maintenance workers of Supply under Article 11.
- (c) The floor upon which a dwelling is located shall be occupied primarily by citizens of the trades assigned to that floor under Article 13, and by the households of such citizens, that the silo's work not be endangered by dispersal of the trades across all floors.
- (d) A citizen's assignment to a dwelling may be revoked by the Head of Supply for failure to keep the dwelling in good repair, for violation of the Pact's requirements concerning the use of a dwelling under Section 3, or for the citizen's reassignment to a new trade requiring residence on a different floor; revocation shall be given in writing, and a citizen may appeal such revocation to Judicial for a ruling.

Section 2. The Zones and the Division of the Silo

The silo is divided into three zones by the character of the work done there and the citizens assigned to each, exactly as Article 1 sets them down: the Up Top, its uppermost levels, where the Mayor, Judicial, the Sheriff, the teachings of the young, and the common areas of assembly and congregation are kept; the Mid Thirties and the Mids beyond them, where most citizen households are located, and the markets, the Infirmary, Information Technology, and the ordinary trades of the silo are carried out; and the Down Deep, the silo's lowest levels, where the Department of Mechanical, the Department of Mines, the generator, the water treatment and stores, and the deep-storage of the silo's reserves are kept, and where only the citizens assigned to those Departments shall ordinarily dwell.

- (a) A citizen may not occupy a dwelling in the Down Deep save where that citizen is assigned by trade to the Department of Mechanical, the Department of Mines, or to a support trade kept deep for the works of those Departments, and no other citizen, save by the explicit written permission of the Head of Supply, may lodge or sleep in the Down Deep overnight.
- (b) The Up Top is reserved for the officers and works of the silo's governance, the teaching of the young, and the common gathering of the

Assembly under Article 20; housing in the Up Top is assigned by the Mayor in consultation with the Head of Supply, and is ordinarily provided only to citizens holding offices under Article 4 and the offices of Judicial under Article 6, and to such teachers and scribes as Article 15 and Article 21 require.

- (c) A citizen of the Mids may petition to work in the Up Top or the Down Deep, and such petition shall be considered under Article 13's labor-assignment process; a citizen successful in such a petition shall be assigned housing on the floor where the citizen's work is situated, or given permission to continue lodging in the Mids and to travel the stairs daily.

Section 3. The Keeping of Dwelling Quarters

A citizen occupying a dwelling is answerable for the condition of that dwelling and for the conduct of the citizen's household within it. The Pact does not compel citizen-to-citizen courtesy or affection; it does compel that a citizen's household not become a hazard or a breach to other citizens in the dwelling or the floor.

- (a) A citizen's household shall not produce vermin, filth, or odor that spreads beyond the dwelling itself, nor shall a citizen's household contain more citizens than the dwelling is assigned to accommodate, nor shall a citizen harbor a citizen unknown to the rolls or hide a child born without the lottery's sanction.
- (b) A citizen may not keep animals not approved under Article 11's Section 5 (sanctioned animals), nor forbid entry to the Maintenance workers of Supply where a repair to the dwelling's systems is required.
- (c) A citizen may not modify the structural integrity of a dwelling, nor seal off doors or passages, nor make permanent alterations without the approval of the Head of Supply and the approval, where relevant, of the Head of Mechanical for concerns affecting the silo's structure.
- (d) A citizen who breaches this section's requirements is answerable under Article 17; if the breach endangers the floor's stability or the water, air, or waste-flow systems under Mechanical's charge, it is among the gravest offenses under Article 17.

Section 4. The Privacy of Dwelling Quarters and the Limits of Search

The Pact recognizes that a citizen's dwelling is a citizen's refuge, and that some matters of household life are private. Nevertheless, the silo's safety and the enforcement of the Pact take precedence over dwelling privacy where the Pact judges they must.

- (a) The Sheriff may enter a dwelling to stop a crime in progress, to investigate a death, or to arrest a citizen for an offense. In all other cases, the Sheriff shall request entry, and may enter only if a citizen of the household consents or if the Judge has ordered a search under Article 6.
- (b) The Officers of Judicial, when executing a search ordered by the Judge under Article 6, may search a dwelling and the citizen's private possessions; such a search shall be conducted in daylight or by lamp, shall not destroy what is searched unnecessarily, and shall be reported to Judicial for the archive under Article 6.
- (c) A search conducted without a Judge's order, or conducted by an officer without the Judge's written order, is a violation of the Pact, and a citizen may refuse entry and may file a complaint with Judicial.

Section 5. Housing and the Equality of Citizens

The Pact provides that every citizen shall have shelter adequate to the citizen's household, and that no citizen shall go unsheltered or displaced without cause grounded in the Pact itself. The Head of Supply, in consultation with the Mayor, shall ensure that no citizen who fulfills the duties of the Pact is left without a dwelling.

- (a) Where a citizen is displaced from a dwelling by catastrophe, by the citizen's release from the mines or from cleaning, or by reassignment of the citizen's trade to a different floor, the Head of Supply shall assign new quarters without undue delay.
- (b) A citizen facing removal from a dwelling for breach of this Article's requirements may petition Judicial for a ruling; Judicial may find the breach overstated, may impose a deadline for remedy before

removal takes effect, or may affirm the removal and order the citizen to a temporary holding pending reassignment.

- (c) The silo's citizens are entitled to housing, not to choice of housing; a citizen may petition for a change of quarters, and the Head of Supply shall consider such a petition in good faith, but is not bound by a citizen's preference where silo needs require otherwise.

Article 15

Of Schooling and the Teaching of the Young

In which is set down how the silo's children are watched, taught, and tested, from the earliest years of the nursery through the founding recitation and the aptitude that finds each child's place, until the citizen's own majority and entry into labor.

Section 1. The Charge of Schooling

Every child born within the silo is owed instruction sufficient to keep the founding as Article 1 records it, to read this Pact and any writing the silo's work requires, and to come to majority fit for the oath and the labor Article 2 and Article 13 lay upon a citizen. Schooling is not a privilege a household purchases or withholds at its own pleasure; it is a duty the silo owes every child, and a duty every household owes the silo in the child's attending.

- (a) Every child, from the age this Article sets down until the citizen's sixteenth naming-day, shall be enrolled in schooling; no household may withhold a child from the schooling this Article requires, save where the Head Physician's judgment excuses attendance for illness or for a season.
- (b) Schooling is provided without charge to any household, its cost borne as a debt of the silo's keeping, the same as the ration under Article 11 and the dwelling under Article 14.

- (c) The purpose of schooling is fourfold: that every child come to know the founding as Article 1 records it; that every child learn to read and reckon sufficient for a trade and a household; that every child's own aptitude be discovered and weighed, as Article 13 provides; and that every child, upon majority, be fit to swear the oath under Article 2 and bear the labor Article 13 assigns.

Section 2. The Ages of Instruction

Every observance this section names is reckoned from the child's naming-day, as Article 2 provides, and not from the day of birth.

- (a) From the third naming-day, a child too young for the schoolroom is kept, while the members of the child's household are at labor, in the nursery under a Nursery Attendant, that the child be watched, fed, and given the earliest teaching of speech, order, and the household's care.
- (b) From the sixth naming-day — the age at which a child is judged to have reached basic societal awareness, sufficient to be held, in some measure, to the order and expectation the schoolroom asks of every child alike — a child is enrolled in the schoolroom proper, and shall attend upon every ordinary working day, save such rest days as this Pact or the child's own household observes.
- (c) Instruction continues, without interruption save for illness, from the sixth naming-day to the sixteenth, at which naming-day a citizen's schooling ends and the citizen's labor, under Article 13, begins in full.
- (d) A child who cannot attend the schoolroom by reason of illness, remoteness of floor, or the household's own labor need shall nonetheless be taught, at the least, the founding recitation and the reading it requires before the child's eighth naming-day, by a teacher sent for that purpose or by such other provision as the schooling of that zone arranges.

Section 3. The Founding and the Limits of Instruction

The founding recitation under Article 1 is the one matter of history this Pact requires every child to be taught, and it is taught whole, exactly as

recorded, and no further.

- (a) Every child shall be taught the founding exactly as Article 1 records it, complete and entire, before the child's eighth naming-day, and no teacher shall add to, subtract from, or embellish that recitation with any further detail of the founders, the manner of the poisoning, or the world before.
- (b) A teacher who instructs a child in any invented detail of the founding as though it were known fact offends under Article 16, Section 3, and offends gravely, whether the teaching arose from the teacher's own error or from the teacher's deliberate invention.
- (c) A child's own questions concerning the founding or the time before shall be answered only in the words Article 1 itself provides; where a child's question reaches beyond what Article 1 records, the teacher shall say plainly that the Pact does not provide more, and shall not speculate before the child.
- (d) This section binds every teacher, every aide, and every other citizen who instructs a child, whether within the schoolroom or without it.

Section 4. The Teachers of the Young

- (a) Teaching the young is a skilled trade entered by full shadowing under Article 13, Section 5, and is further an order-adjacent trade under Article 13, Section 6; a citizen shadowing to become a teacher undergoes, beyond the shadowing itself, such vetting as Article 13 there provides, and remains subject to that vetting throughout the citizen's tenure in the trade.
- (b) A teacher confirmed in the trade is housed, where the teacher's assignment requires it, among the Up Top under Article 14, Section 2, that the teacher be near the schoolroom the teacher serves.
- (c) A School Aide may be taken on by short shadowing under Article 13, to assist a teacher in the ordinary care and instruction of the youngest children, and to serve the nursery under a Nursery Attendant; an aide does not teach the founding recitation or the course of study under Section 5 without a teacher present.
- (d) No citizen may instruct a child in the schoolroom, the nursery, or in place of formal schooling, save a citizen confirmed as a teacher or aide under this section, or a parent or guardian teaching a child

some matter this Pact does not reserve to the schoolroom, such as a trade skill or a household craft.

Section 5. The Course of Study

- (a) Every child shall be taught to read and write, to reckon numbers sufficient for a trade and for the keeping of a household, and to know this Pact's structure and the citizen's own duties under it, that the citizen may swear the oath under Article 2 with genuine understanding.
- (b) Every child shall be taught the structure of the silo under Article 1, the offices of its governance, and the ordinary safety of the stairwell, the wallscreen, and the floors, that the child grow into a citizen who keeps the silo's order from knowledge and not from fear alone.
- (c) The course of study is set by Judicial, in consultation with the teachers of every zone, that a citizen taught on one floor be no less prepared than a citizen taught on another; a teacher may add local instruction suited to a floor's own trades, but may not omit any part of the course this section requires.
- (d) Beyond the tenth naming-day, a child's course of study shall include a survey of the silo's trades, described plainly and without preference, that a child's own aptitude testing under Article 13 be met with some earlier acquaintance with the choices before them.
- (e) The course of study set under this section does not include instruction in the working of wire, radio, lens, or fine instrument, whatever a child's own aptitude for such work may show; such instruction is given only within Information Technology's own shadowing under Article 13, to a citizen the Department has itself found fit to receive it.

Section 6. Aptitude, the Approach of Majority, and the Passage into Labor

- (a) From the twelfth naming-day, the schools under this Article shall assess each child's aptitude for labor as Article 13, Section 2 provides, and shall record the results for the child's own guidance and for the Head of Department's later reference.

- (b) In a child's final two years of schooling, from the fourteenth naming-day to the sixteenth, a child may be placed, with the household's consent and the relevant Head of Department's leave, in a trial placement of no more than a season's length within a trade of the child's own aptitude or desire, that the child come to know labor's demands before being bound to them. A trial placement is not a shadowing under Article 13, confers no standing in the trade, and may be ended by the Department, the school, or the household at any time.
- (c) A child's schooling does not end for a trial placement; the child remains subject to this Article's course of study and to the teacher's charge until the citizen's sixteenth naming-day.
- (d) Upon a citizen's sixteenth naming-day, schooling ends, the citizen swears the oath under Article 2, and the citizen's shadowing or labor assignment begins under Article 13; a trial placement completed under this section may be credited toward the citizen's later shadowing, at the discretion of the Head of the Department in which the trial was made.

Section 7. The Correction and Wellbeing of Children

- (a) A child is a ward of the household or floor to which the child is assigned, and holds, under Article 2, Section 1, every duty of a citizen of the child's years, but not the standing to petition Judicial directly; where a child's matter must be brought before Judicial, the household or, in its absence, the teacher shall bring it.
- (b) Ordinary correction of a child within the schoolroom — a delay of privilege, additional labor about the schoolroom, a report to the household — is the teacher's own charge, and is not an offense under Article 17 nor an occasion for Judicial's hearing.
- (c) A grave breach of the Pact by a child too young for majority is not answered under Article 17 as though the child were a citizen of full standing. Judicial shall hear the matter with the household present, and shall weigh the child's years in fixing whatever correction, restitution, or instruction the matter requires, saving always the gravest offenses named in Article 17, which Judicial may refer upward regardless of the offender's years.

- (d) A teacher who observes in a child a persistent distress, a defiance of correction beyond the ordinary, or a fixation upon some matter this Pact does not teach, shall report the matter to the Head Physician under Article 19 or to Judicial, that the child's needs be seen to. Such a report is not itself a charge against the child, and creates no mark upon the child's roll under Article 21 save the fact of the report and its resolution.

Section 8. Records of Schooling and Attendance

- (a) Every school shall keep a roll of its enrolled children, their attendance, and the results of the aptitude testing under Section 6, and shall report the roll to Judicial not less than once yearly, for entry into the citizen's record under Article 21.
- (b) A household that fails, without cause recognized under Section 2, to send a child to schooling as this Article requires is answerable under Article 17; repeated failure may be referred to Judicial for a ruling on the household's fitness to keep the child, without prejudice to the household's ordinary standing in all other matters.
- (c) A citizen's schooling record — attendance, aptitude testing, and any trial placement under Section 6 — is kept in the Judicial archive alongside the citizen's other records under Article 21, and is open to the citizen upon majority and to the citizen's own household before it, but to no other citizen save by Judicial's order.

Article 16

Of Public Order and Forbidden Speech

In which is set down what a citizen may not say, may not keep, and may not make, that the silo's order and the silo's peace may both be kept whole.

Section 1. The Forbidden Word

No citizen may speak, write, or otherwise give voice to a wish, a request, or a suggestion that a citizen be permitted outside the silo, save the citizen's own request made directly and finally under Article 18, which this Pact answers in full and does not treat as an offense.

- (a) No citizen may teach, suggest, or give another citizen cause to believe that the world above is fit, in whole or in part, for the living of a life, whether by word, by writing, or by any other means.
- (b) A citizen who hears another citizen give voice to the wish named above, and does not report it to the Sheriff or to Judicial without delay, is answerable alongside the citizen who gave it voice, under Article 17.

Section 2. Rumor, Despair, and the Spread of Discontent

No citizen may spread, as though it were known fact, a rumor of the silo's coming failure, of a coming shortage this Pact and its Departments have

not themselves declared, or of any other matter likely to move citizens toward panic, hoarding, or unrest.

- (a) No citizen may gather other citizens, beyond the ordinary gathering of a floor, a trade, or a household, or an assembly held under Article 20, for a purpose this Pact does not name, without leave of the Sheriff, sought and given beforehand.
- (b) This section does not forbid a citizen's own grief, doubt, or complaint, spoken to another citizen in the ordinary way of living; it forbids only the giving of that grief, doubt, or complaint the shape of a fact this Pact has not itself declared.

Section 3. False Teaching of the Founding and the Past

No citizen shall invent detail of the founding, the silo's building, or the time before beyond what Article 1 records, and teach that invention to another as though it were known fact.

- (a) A citizen who studies or speculates upon the founding or the time before, privately and without teaching the invention to another as fact, does not offend under this section; a citizen who teaches a child, in a place of schooling under Article 15 or otherwise, any invented detail as fact, offends gravely, whatever the citizen's own belief in the invention's truth.
- (b) This section binds every citizen equally, of every office, and no office excuses the teaching of invented history as fact under this section.

Section 4. Relics of the Time Before

A relic is any object, writing, device, or likeness made before the silo's sealing, or bearing upon its making, its history, or the world above, save such an object as this Pact or Judicial has sanctioned for a citizen's keeping.

- (a) A citizen who finds or comes to hold a relic shall surrender it to the Sheriff without delay, who shall carry it to Judicial for classification; Judicial shall enter every relic so surrendered in its archive under Article 6, together with its finding, its classification, and its citizen.

A citizen who surrenders a relic during a Forgiveness Holiday declared under Article 4 does so under the grace that Article provides, and not under fear of the ordinary consequence of having kept it.

- (b) Judicial shall classify a relic by the danger it poses to the silo's order. A relic bearing upon the founding, the time before, or the world above in a way that could teach a citizen to doubt what Article 1 records is classified among the gravest, and is destroyed or sealed beyond any citizen's reach, at Judicial's own discretion, once its examination under Article 8 is complete. A relic posing lesser danger may be classified otherwise, and a citizen who finds such a relic may petition Judicial to sanction its keeping.
- (c) A relic sanctioned for a citizen's keeping under this section remains the silo's to reclassify, and a sanction once given may be withdrawn by a later ruling of the Judge under Article 6.

Section 5. Restricted Instruments and Devices

No citizen may make, keep, or use any lens or glass that magnifies beyond the ordinary power of reading spectacles, any device that sends or receives word without a wire strung and licensed under Article 8, any fine instrument for the working of metal, wire, or glass, or any device made to carry a citizen's own body between floors, save under a license issued by Information Technology under Article 8 or Article 9.

- (a) An instrument or device named in this section, found in a citizen's keeping without license, is a relic under Section 4, and is classified among the gravest unless Judicial finds cause, upon examination under Article 8, to classify it otherwise.

Section 6. Tampering with Surveillance and Monitoring Systems

Information Technology under Article 8 maintains apparatus throughout the silo for observation, communication, and the monitoring of the silo's vital systems, as this Pact elsewhere describes. No citizen may locate, identify, tamper with, disable, cover, or interfere with any apparatus maintained by Information Technology for the silo's observation or surveillance, whether such apparatus is known to the citizen or suspected.

- (a) A citizen who discovers the location of a monitoring or surveillance device shall not reveal the location to any other citizen, nor may the citizen tamper with, disable, or conceal the device. Discovery of such a device must be reported immediately to Information Technology or to the Sheriff.
- (b) A citizen who deliberately attempts to locate surveillance apparatus for the purpose of interfering with it, or who successfully disables or obscures such apparatus, is answerable under Article 17 among the gravest offenses, as interference with the silo's safety infrastructure.
- (c) Information Technology shall maintain surveillance apparatus in such locations and configurations as Information Technology determines necessary, and the specific locations and methods are not subject to disclosure to ordinary citizens, being part of Information Technology's charge under Article 8.

Article 17

Of Crimes and Their Punishments

In which is set down how an offense is measured, how a first offense is forgiven, and how a citizen answers, in the mines or in the cleaning, for every offense that is not.

Section 1. The Three Measures of Correction

This Pact answers a broken law in one of three measures: a grace given for a first offense under Section 2; a term in the mines for an offense named under Section 3; or cleaning under Article 18 for an offense named among the gravest under Section 4.

- (a) No offense is answered by more than one of these measures, and no citizen may be given a lesser measure for a gravest offense, nor a greater measure for an offense this Pact does not name among the gravest, whatever the Judge's own judgment of the citizen's character.
- (b) Where this Pact does not name the measure that answers an offense, the Judge shall rule under Article 6, and that ruling shall thereafter stand as though the measure were named here.

Section 2. The Grace of a First Offense

A citizen's first offense under this Pact, save an offense named among the gravest under Section 4, is answered by a grace: a formal warning entered in the Judicial archive under Article 6, and no term in the mines.

- (a) A grace is given once to a citizen in their lifetime, for the whole of the offenses this Pact does not name among the gravest, and not once for every kind of offense a citizen might commit.
- (b) A second offense, of any kind not among the gravest, is answered by the mines under Section 3, whatever grace the citizen was earlier given.

Section 3. Offenses Answered by the Mines

The following, upon a second offense or upon a first offense the Judge finds too grave for grace, are answered by a term in the mines: the diversion or waste of food, feed, or stores under Article 11; the keeping of an animal without sanction under Article 11; standing responsible, under Article 2, for a birth without the lottery's grant of Article 3; speaking or teaching the forbidden wish under Article 16 Section 1; the willful and persistent neglect of assigned labor, referred by a Head of Department under Article 13 and found by Judicial to continue notwithstanding that referral; and the keeping, making, or use of any relic or restricted instrument or device forbidden under Article 8, Article 9, or Article 16, without license, save where Article 16 classifies that relic among the gravest.

- (a) A term in the mines is a term of labor in the deep workings below the Down Deep, under the direction of the Head of Mechanical, for a span the Judge sets and the Judge alone may shorten.
- (b) A citizen serving a term in the mines remains a citizen for every purpose of this Pact, and returns, upon the term's ending, to the trade and floor Judicial assigns, which need not be the trade or floor held before.

Section 4. Offenses Among the Gravest

The following are named among the gravest offenses under this Pact, and are answered by cleaning under Article 18, without the grace of Section 2 or the hearing Article 6 grants for a lesser offense: tampering with,

obstructing, or attempting private repair of the outward sensors, under Article 1; interference with the generator, the works of water and air, or the labor of reclamation, under Article 9; making a false attestation of a citizen's life or death, under Article 2; the taking, or the attempt to take, of a citizen's own life by any means not sought and granted under Article 18; and the keeping, making, or use of any relic Article 16 classifies among the gravest.

- (a) The Judge alone may name a further offense among the gravest, by a ruling under Article 6, and that ruling shall state plainly why the offense is found to threaten the whole silo and not merely the citizen who committed it.
- (b) Nothing named among the gravest offenses under this Article may be answered by any measure but cleaning, and no citizen sentenced under this section may be sentenced instead to the mines, whatever representation is made under Article 6.
- (c) Where a citizen's own life is taken and the citizen does not survive to be sentenced, Judicial's finding under this section is entered in the archive under Article 6 and closes the citizen's name under Article 2, and no further punishment is had; a citizen who survives an attempt under this section is sentenced to cleaning as for any other offense named in this Article.

Section 5. Offenses Against Another Citizen

A citizen who does violence upon another, who takes what is not theirs, or who otherwise wrongs a citizen in body or property, is answerable under this Article, and the Judge shall set the measure — grace, the mines, or, where the wrong was done with intent to kill or maim, among the gravest — according to the wrong done and the harm that came of it.

- (a) A wrong done under this section is Judicial's to judge, whether or not the wronged citizen brings it forward, but a citizen who brings a wrong forward and is found to have brought it falsely is answerable, under this same section, for the false bringing.
- (b) Where a wrong under this section, or an order given and later found unnecessary under Article 22, has cost a citizen property, labor, or standing, the Judge may order the offending party, or the silo itself where Article 22 so provides, to make restitution to the wronged citizen or the wronged citizen's household, in chits, goods, or labor,

in addition to whatever measure of grace, the mines, or cleaning the wrong itself requires. Restitution is not itself a measure of correction under Section 1, and its ordering neither lessens nor replaces the measure that section requires.

Article 18

Of the Cleaning

In which is set down the gravest sentence this Pact names: the sending of a citizen outside to clean, that the silo may endure and every other citizen may live.

Section 1. The Request and the Right of a Citizen

No citizen may be compelled to walk outside the silo, to touch the lenses or sensors, or to approach the airlock against that citizen's will. Yet any citizen, at any time, may request to go outside, and that request must be granted. This choice, once made, is final and irrevocable. A citizen granted this request is released from all bonds of the silo and all claims to the rolls, and is known thereafter as a cleaner.

- (a) A citizen may make a final request at any point in the citizen's life, to any officer of Judicial or to the Sheriff, or may write it down and place it in the archive under Article 6, by speaking or setting down these words and no others: "I wish to walk outside." No further explanation is required of the citizen, and none shall be asked; the words alone, once said in earnest and to a proper officer, are the whole of the request this Pact requires.
- (b) The request does not need to be approved, discussed, or delayed; it shall be granted with utmost expedience.
- (c) A citizen who makes a final request shall be brought to the airlock on the next available cycle, clothed in a suit provided by Information

Technology under Section 3 of this Article, and the citizen shall walk outside. No Pact provides a method by which a citizen might return, and none is needed, for every request is final.

- (d) A citizen who walks outside remains a citizen in the rolls until Judicial is informed by Information Technology under Article 8 that the sensors confirm the citizen's death; only then is the citizen's name closed under Article 2.

Section 2. The Obligation to Clean and the Sentencing to Cleaning

A citizen sentenced to cleaning is not condemned as a murderer is condemned; rather, a citizen sentenced to cleaning is a citizen who has violated the Pact in a way that threatens the whole silo, and the silo has determined that such a citizen is a danger to all others and must be removed. This is not a death sentence; it is an exile.

- (a) The Judge alone sentences a citizen to cleaning, for an offense named among the gravest under Article 17. No citizen sentenced to cleaning may be reprieved, pardoned, or offered mercy by any other office.
- (b) A citizen sentenced to cleaning shall be prepared by the Infirmary under Article 19 for the journey outside: clothed in a suit, provided such water or food as that preparation requires, and made ready without delay.
- (c) A citizen sentenced to cleaning is brought to the airlock and is sent outside on the next available cycle, exactly as a citizen making a final request, and the two are thereafter indistinguishable: both are cleaners, and both are lost to the silo.

Section 3. The Suits and the Seals

The Pact does not name the fate of a citizen who walks outside, nor does it describe how long a citizen might last in the air above. The silo's knowing or not knowing of that fate is no citizen's concern. The suit provided is assembled in the cleaning lab under the charge of Information Technology, from cloth, seals, and fittings supplied by Mechanical and Supply, tested to hold for such time as the silo judges reasonable, and made ready with the utmost care.

- (a) The suit provided to any citizen sent to clean is assembled and sealed to a specification set by Information Technology, exercised under such further procedure as that Department alone is instructed in, this Pact not setting down that procedure here, for it is no part of ordinary citizenship. Mechanical and Supply furnish the cloth, seals, and fittings the specification requires, but the specification itself, and the final sealing, are Information Technology's alone. A suit known to be faulty shall not be sent out.
- (b) Information Technology under Article 8 monitors the sensors after a citizen emerges to confirm the citizen has begun and completed the cleaning, and reports this finding to Judicial for the archive under Article 6. The citizen is not informed of the manner of their death, nor of the time it takes.
- (c) A citizen being prepared for cleaning retains the right to refuse the suit; such a refusal is not grounds for a stay or a reprieve, and the citizen is brought outside without the suit.
- (d) The citizens of Information Technology who assemble, seal, and administer the suit and the chamber are entered into that trade only by full shadowing under Article 13, and are vetted beyond the ordinary measure Article 13 there provides, as befits a trade nearer than any other to the silo's gravest and most final procedure. The particulars of that further vetting are kept by the Head of Information Technology and are no part of ordinary citizenship.

Section 4. The Airlock and the Departure

The airlock stands at the silo's uppermost level, beyond the wallscreen and its cafeteria, and it is through this chamber alone that a citizen sent to clean departs the silo. This section sets down the plain administration of that departure, that it be carried out with the same order the silo asks of every other procedure it keeps.

- (a) Before the outer door is opened, the citizen is given no fewer than three and no more than five pads of raw wool, drawn from a store kept for this purpose alone and logged, by number issued and number remaining, in the chamber's own record, that the citizen may, once outside, wipe clean the lenses of the outward sensors, so that the wallscreen's image may continue to be gathered as true as it can be kept. A citizen sent to clean under sentence performs this wiping

before any other act; a citizen departed by final request performs it if the citizen is willing, and is asked no further than once.

- (b) Before the flush begins, the Officer of Judicial or the Sheriff who brought the citizen to the chamber confirms the inner door is sealed, enters the hour of sealing in the chamber's record by the silo's own clock, and reports the sealing to the technician of Information Technology who oversees the chamber, who countersigns the same entry. The chamber is then sealed and flushed of the silo's own air, by a gas Information Technology alone administers and this Pact does not further describe, that the poison of the world above not be carried back into the silo with the door's opening; the technician enters the flush's completion in the same record, by the same hour and countersignature this section already requires.
- (c) Only once the technician of Information Technology has made the entry required above, confirming the chamber is flushed and the citizen is suited and sealed, does the outer door open. The Officer or Sheriff who accompanied the citizen does not enter the chamber for this final step, and returns to ordinary duty once the inner door is sealed behind the citizen and the record's first entry is made.

Section 5. The Public Witnessing of a Cleaning

A cleaning at the wallscreen of the cafeteria is neither compulsory for any citizen to attend, nor forbidden. The citizens who gather to watch do so of their own choice, and the Sheriff ensures peace among them as any other gathering under Article 7.

- (a) A cleaning is displayed on the wallscreen at the Level 1 cafeteria as it occurs, exactly as the camera and the sensors capture it, without interruption or interference, so that all who wish to know may see the fate of the citizen sent out.
- (b) The gathering to watch is the charge of the Sheriff under Article 7, and the Sheriff shall keep order as at any other public place, and may disperse a crowd that threatens to become disorder, though the gathering itself may not be forbidden.
- (c) After a cleaning is complete, the image on the wallscreen ceases, and the visual record of what transpired outside is kept in the archive under Article 6, preserved for the record but not displayed further.

Section 6. The Ritual and the Meaning

The cleaning is not cruelty, though it appears so to the citizen sent to it. It is the silo's answer to those offenses that endanger not a single citizen but all citizens at once. The sensor tampering, the interference with vital systems, the self-killing of a citizen, the forging of the rolls — these strike at the whole, and the whole must answer.

- (a) No citizen shall be sent to cleaning for a lesser crime than those named under Article 17, Section 4. No Judge may increase this severity, nor may any other office. This severity is fixed and irrevocable.
- (b) The families of citizens sent to cleaning are not barred from continuing to live in the silo, nor marked, nor punished under this Pact, save where the family member themselves has violated the Pact. A child born to a parent who was cleaned is entered in the rolls exactly as any other child.
- (c) A citizen watching a cleaning, or witnessing its aftermath in the archive, shall draw such meaning as the citizen finds there. This Pact provides the mechanism but not the interpretation. The silo persists because such measures are taken, and every citizen's life depends on this.

Article 19

Of Health, the Infirmary, and the Mind

In which is set down the care of citizen health, the charge of the Infirmary and the Physicians who tend it, mandatory care for health and the prevention of disease, and the disposition of citizens determined unable to sustain themselves through labor.

Section 1. The Charge and the Physicians

The Department of the Infirmary is charged with the health of every citizen: the prevention of disease, the care and recovery of the sick and injured, the certification of fitness for trade and for labor, and the keeping of the records of every citizen's health that the Pact requires. The Infirmary is located on floors within the Mids and is run by the Physicians of the Infirmary, led by a Head Physician appointed and confirmed under the shadowing process of Article 13.

The Infirmary's charge extends to the disorders and afflictions of a citizen's mind no less than of the citizen's body: a Physician who examines a citizen troubled in mind keeps the same record, in the same confidence, and by the same procedure as for any other complaint, and no citizen is treated for such a trouble save by a Physician under this Article.

- (a) A Physician of the Infirmary is licensed by the Head Physician to undertake medical care, and may administer medicines, set broken bones, suture wounds, treat a citizen's disorders of mind, and determine the cause of death under Article 2; no other citizen may

undertake such care save where no Physician is available and immediate aid is required to preserve life.

- (b) The Infirmary shall keep records of every citizen's health that the Infirmary observes or is told of: inoculations, treatments received, injuries, illnesses, and such conditions as affect the citizen's fitness for certain labors. These records are kept in the Judicial archive under Article 6, and remain confidential, open to the citizen named and to Judicial only, save where this Pact elsewhere requires disclosure.
- (c) A citizen shall have the right to refuse medical treatment, save where the Pact expressly compels it (treatment of a communicable disease that threatens the silo; the mandatory health screening set out in Section 2; the examination and restraint of a citizen found incompetent to stand for trial under Article 6).

Section 2. Mandatory Care and the Keeping of Health

Every citizen is required to maintain the citizen's own health and to make regular use of the Infirmary's resources for the examination, inoculation, and prevention of disease, as set down by the Head Physician and the Mayor. A citizen who does not maintain such care may be reassigned by the relevant Department head to simpler labor less demanding of health or strength, or to retirement if no lighter labor is available.

- (a) Every citizen of majority shall submit, at intervals set by the Head Physician, to a comprehensive health screening: examination of the citizen's body, testing of the citizen's health records, and attestation of fitness or unfitness for the citizen's current trade. A citizen found unfit by a screening may be reassigned or medically restricted under Article 13.
- (b) A citizen who refuses or repeatedly avoids a mandatory health screening may be compelled to attend by the Sheriff, provided Judicial is notified; a citizen compelled by the Sheriff is entitled to a hearing before Judicial as to whether the screening was in fact mandatory and lawfully required.
- (c) The use of recreational facilities (exercise yards, baths, steam rooms, organized sports) is made available by the Infirmary and the Department of Supply for every citizen's health, and citizens are encour-

aged, but not compelled, to make use of them. Where a citizen's health is observed to be seriously declining, the Head Physician may recommend reassignment or restricted labor as a condition of continued health.

- (d) Citizens of majority shall maintain awareness of emergency-health procedures: the location of the nearest aid station, the treatment of burns and wounds, the recognition of communicable illness and the obligation to report it. Teaching of such matters is the charge of Article 15 (schooling) and the Infirmary itself.

Section 3. Communicable Illness and the Isolation of the Sick

The Infirmary has the authority to isolate a citizen believed to have a communicable illness, to compel treatment, and to restrict the citizen's movement and contact with others, all in service to the silo's collective health. No citizen's individual preference overrides this necessity.

- (a) A Physician who believes a citizen to be suffering from a communicable disease shall isolate that citizen, notify Judicial and the Sheriff, and undertake such treatment as the Physician judges necessary. The citizen is entitled to food, water, and care during isolation, but may not leave the isolation area without the Head Physician's written permission.
- (b) A citizen who violates the isolation ordered by a Physician, or who knowingly exposes others to a communicable illness, is answerable under Article 17 for endangerment.
- (c) The silo's water, air, waste disposal, and food-handling are monitored by the Infirmary in consultation with the Department of Mechanical under Article 9 and the Department of Supply under Article 11, that the spread of disease through the silo's systems be prevented.

Section 4. Death and the Determination of Cause

When a citizen dies, a Physician of the Infirmary shall examine the body and determine the cause of death, entering the finding in the Infirmary

records and reporting to Judicial under Article 2. This is the cornerstone of the silo's records and the Judicial archive's understanding of how citizens pass.

- (a) A Physician who examines a body shall, to the best of the Physician's knowledge, determine and report the cause of death, entering the finding upon the Infirmary's own Form of Death — the citizen's name and naming-day, the floor and hour the body was found, the examining Physician's own name, and the finding itself, set down in that order and no other — including whether the death is believed to be by illness, injury, age, or by the citizen's own will outside the clean request under Article 18.
- (b) Where a citizen is believed to have caused the citizen's own death by means other than a clean request under Article 18, the Physician shall report this finding to Judicial upon the same Form, and Judicial shall investigate and determine whether the finding is accurate before closing the rolls under Article 2. This investigation is not delayed; Judicial shall make its determination within a season.
- (c) Where a citizen dies by the cleaning procedure under Article 18, the Form of Death this section otherwise requires is not completed, and a Physician need not be present; Information Technology under Article 8 shall certify instead, by its own record and in its own keeping, that the sensors were properly maintained and the procedure was carried out as ordained, and this certification is sufficient for Judicial to close the rolls, provided no evidence suggests the cleaning was sought other than by the citizen's own final request.
- (d) A Physician who falsifies a cause of death, or who fails to report a suspected self-killing to Judicial, is answerable under Article 17 among the gravest offenses.

Section 5. Retirement and the Care of the Aged and Infirm

A citizen who can no longer perform the labor assigned to the citizen—whether by age, illness, or injury—may be retired from labor under Article 13 and shall be cared for by the silo. The Infirmary and the Department of Supply together manage the provision of housing, food, medicine, and comfort for the retired.

- (a) A citizen may petition for retirement after reaching the age at which the Head Physician and the Mayor jointly determine that further labor is no longer expected or possible. A citizen may also petition for early retirement if a chronic illness or permanent injury makes the citizen's current trade impossible; such a petition shall be referred to Judicial for a ruling.
- (b) A retired citizen continues to receive the ration of a citizen under Article 11, plus additional provisions for medicine or care if the Infirmary judges it necessary. A retired citizen's housing is assigned under Article 14 and may not be revoked save by the Head of Supply in consultation with the Head Physician.
- (c) A retired citizen who recovers strength or fitness sufficient to undertake lighter labor may petition to return to work; if approved by the Head Physician and the relevant Department head, the citizen may reenter a trade and will no longer receive retirement provisions beyond the ordinary ration.

Section 6. Physicians' Judgment and At-Risk Referral

A Physician of the Infirmary holds responsibility for the wellbeing of the citizens under their care. Where a Physician believes a citizen to be in immediate and critical danger of self-harm, the Physician may refer that citizen to Judicial for protective evaluation and care.

- (a) A Physician who believes a citizen to be in immediate, critical danger of self-harm or deterioration may refer that citizen to Judicial for protective evaluation, using the Physician's own judgment. No Physician is obligated to refer citizens believed to be at risk of lesser danger or slow decline.
- (b) A citizen who fears the citizen is in danger of self-harm may petition Judicial directly for protective evaluation, and may request the Infirmary's care and support without waiting for a Physician's referral. A citizen who petitions Judicial under this clause is entitled to a hearing as to the necessity and form of any protective measures.
- (c) A Physician who observes in a citizen a persistent fixation upon some matter this Pact does not teach or require, carried to the neglect of the citizen's own health, household, or labor, may refer the citizen to Judicial for evaluation under this section, using the

Physician's own judgment; no Physician is obligated to make such a referral. A referral under this clause is not itself a charge against the citizen, and creates no mark upon the citizen's record under Article 21 save the fact of the referral and its resolution.

Section 7. Fitness for Critical Roles and the Syndrome

Certain positions carry responsibilities that demand full physical and mental acuity. The Infirmary and Judicial work together to ensure that a citizen holding a critical role under Article 13 is fit to do so, and to identify cases where a citizen's affliction or infirmity requires immediate attention and possible removal from the role.

- (a) A Physician of the Infirmary may, at any time, refer a citizen holding a critical role to Judicial if the Physician believes the citizen's health—mental or physical—is compromised in a way that threatens the silo's safety or the citizen's ability to perform the role. This referral is confidential until Judicial determines whether cause exists to remove the citizen.
- (b) No citizen afflicted with the Syndrome—a degenerative neurological condition characterized by tremors, progressive cognitive decline, and nervous-system deterioration—may hold a critical role, and any citizen in a critical role diagnosed with the Syndrome shall immediately report this to the Head Physician, resign from the role, and undertake the treatment the Infirmary recommends.
- (c) The Infirmary shall maintain confidential records of every citizen's Syndrome status, made known to Judicial only where a citizen holds or seeks a critical role. Diagnosis of the Syndrome does not mark a citizen as unfit for ordinary labor; it marks only that the citizen may not undertake work bearing direct responsibility for the silo's welfare or the lives of other citizens.

Article 20

Of Assembly and the Common Halls

In which is set down the Assembly of citizens, the common halls where the Assembly gathers, the speaking of citizens before the Assembly, and the will of the Assembly to amend this Pact or overturn the Mayor's or Judicial's acts where the Pact requires it.

Section 1. The Assembly of Citizens

The Assembly is the body of all citizens of majority, gathered in one place or by messenger-relay across the floors under Article 20, to hear the Mayor's report and the concerns of the silo, to confirm or remove the Mayor from office, to confirm or remove the Judge from office, to ratify amendments to this Pact, and to rule on disputes between the Mayor and Judicial where this Pact requires their judgment.

- (a) The Mayor convenes the Assembly once yearly, at a time of the Mayor's choosing, to report on the silo's condition and to make recommendations to the citizens. Any citizen of majority may attend this ordinary Assembly and speak.
- (b) The Assembly may be convened in extraordinary session by petition of one fifth of the silo's population of majority, or by the Mayor, or by Judicial where this Pact requires the Assembly's judgment on a matter between the Mayor and Judicial. An extraordinary session must be called within fourteen days of the petition or circumstance requiring it.

- (c) No Assembly session shall last longer than three days without recess; a matter that requires deliberation longer than three days shall be put to the Assembly again, not in continuous session.
- (d) A citizen may send a message to the Assembly in their stead under Article 20, if the citizen is unable to attend in person; such a message may be read aloud in the Assembly and is recorded in the archive.

Section 2. The Common Halls and the Gathering

The Assembly gathers in the large common halls on the Up Top, which are kept by the Department of Supply under Article 11. These halls are reserved for the Assembly and for such other gathering as the Mayor authorizes under Article 4.

- (a) The main common hall of the Assembly, on Level 1, can hold several hundred citizens, and the Mayor shall ensure adequate seating and ventilation for the Assembly. Where more citizens wish to attend than the hall can hold, the overflow may gather at secondary halls and relay the proceedings by porter-relay or, where Information Technology under Article 8 has provided the means, by radio relay to other floors.
- (b) The Sheriff keeps order in the common halls where the Assembly gathers, and may remove a citizen who disrupts the Assembly, provided the citizen is given the reason for removal and may request a hearing before Judicial as to whether the removal was lawful.
- (c) A citizen making a spectacle or a threat in the Assembly halls is answerable under Article 17 as for public disruption or endangerment of the Assembly itself.
- (d) The common halls that serve as cafeterias open before the first labor of the day and close after the last, save the Down Deep's own hall, kept to the hours of Mechanical's and Mines's own shifts; a citizen whose labor keeps unusual hours may petition the relevant Head of Department for standing leave to draw food outside these hours, and such leave, once granted, need not be asked again.
- (e) Where the press of citizens wishing to witness a cleaning at the Level 1 wallscreen exceeds the hall's capacity, seating is granted by the same lottery Article 3 provides for the bearing of children, drawn

separately and for this purpose alone, that the granting of a scarce place be seen to rest on chance and not on favor.

Section 3. The Hearing Before the Assembly

Any citizen may petition to speak before the Assembly, and the Assembly shall hear petitions from any citizen who wishes to raise a matter of silo concern. The Mayor sets the time and order of speaking, but may not refuse a citizen the right to speak, save where the citizen has already disrupted an Assembly.

- (a) A citizen wishing to speak must declare the subject of the address, and the Mayor may set limits on the time of speaking (no single citizen more than a few minutes; a matter of great complexity may be split across multiple speakers or multiple Assembly sessions).
- (b) A citizen's address to the Assembly is entered in the archive under Article 6 and may not be censored or removed, save where the address itself is sedition or forbidden speech under Article 16, in which case the Judge may review the archive copy and rule whether the address was rightfully censored.
- (c) A citizen who speaks to the Assembly is protected from retaliation under this Pact; any citizen punished by a Department, the Sheriff, or the Mayor for the fact of having spoken to the Assembly is answerable under Article 17 as for breach of the Pact.

Section 4. The Assembly's Powers of Confirmation and Removal

The Assembly, together with the Mayor or Judicial as the case requires, confirms citizens to the highest offices and may remove them. The Mayor serves at the Assembly's pleasure, and the Judge serves at the Assembly's and Mayor's pleasure.

- (a) The Assembly, in extraordinary session, votes on the removal of the Mayor by petition or by recommendation from Judicial; a removal vote passes upon the affirmative vote of two thirds of the Assembly present.
- (b) The Assembly, in extraordinary session and joined by the Mayor, votes on the confirmation of a new Judge or the removal of a sitting

Judge; a confirmation requires a simple majority, and a removal requires two thirds.

- (c) The Assembly shall, when the Mayor convenes an ordinary session, receive a report from the Mayor on the major decisions, standing orders, and resource allocations of the past year, and may petition Judicial to rule on whether any such decision violated the Pact.

Section 5. The Amendment of This Pact

This Pact may be amended only by the Assembly, upon petition from the Mayor or from one fifth of the citizens of majority, and the amendment must pass by two thirds of the Assembly present. Amendments are entered in the archive and in a separate roll of amendments under Article 23.

- (a) The Mayor may recommend an amendment to this Pact and shall present the text of the proposed amendment to the Assembly for deliberation and vote.
- (b) Any citizen or group of citizens may petition for an amendment, provided the petition is signed by at least one fifth of the silo's population of majority, and the Assembly shall vote on the proposed amendment.
- (c) An amendment, once ratified by the Assembly, becomes part of this Pact and binds the silo from that date forward, exactly as if it had been written at the Pact's founding.
- (d) No amendment shall contradict a previous amendment or a prior Pact provision without explicitly repealing or replacing that provision; all amendments are entered in the roll and the archive, so the silo's citizens and Judicial may see how this Pact has grown and changed over time.

Article 21

Of Records, Porters, and the Post

In which is set down the keeping of records throughout the silo, the carrying of messages by porters where the radio and wire cannot reach, and the obligation that every transaction of consequence to the silo be preserved in the archive for the memory of the silo's own history.

Section 1. The Keeping of Records

Every record the Pact requires to be kept in the Judicial archive under Article 6 is the responsibility of Judicial to keep whole, accurate, and protected from alteration. These records are the silo's memory, and the silo's memory is the silo's greatest treasure after the lives of its citizens.

- (a) The Judicial archive keeps every ruling, every sentence, every death-finding, every amendment, every standing order of the Mayor, and every record of crime and punishment that the Pact assigns to its keeping.
- (b) The archive is kept on Level 1, in the Up Top, in a room secured against fire, flood, and interference, and accessible to Judicial officers only, to the Mayor for review of standing orders, and to any citizen who petitions Judicial to see a record concerning that citizen's own business.
- (c) A citizen may petition to view any record concerning the citizen or the citizen's household, and Judicial shall grant access within one

cycle; Judicial may refuse access to records of ongoing investigation or trial, provided the citizen is told the reason for the refusal.

- (d) The archive is backed by a secondary roll kept in secure keeping by the Head of Supply under Article 11, that if fire or catastrophe should strike the primary archive, the silo's records are not wholly lost.

Section 2. The Porters and the Carrying of Word

Where a message must travel between floors faster than a citizen might walk, or where a message must be kept private between the sender and the recipient, a porter carries the word. Porters are assigned by the Department of Supply under Article 11 and travel the stairs under protection from the Sheriff.

- (a) A citizen of majority may become a porter, and porters are trained by Supply in the keeping of messages, the swift travel of the stairs, and the protection of their charges. A porter's shadow under Article 13 shall be one season or two, as the Head of Supply determines.
- (b) A porter carrying a message has the right of way on the stairs under Article 7; any citizen must yield the porter's passage, and the Sheriff ensures this right is honored.
- (c) A message carried by a porter is sealed if the sender wishes it sealed, and a porter may not read a sealed message, nor may a citizen intercept a message from a porter without the porter's consent, save the Sheriff or Judicial may do so in pursuit of an investigation. An unsealed message is assumed to be open to ordinary view.
- (d) A porter who breaks a sealed message is answerable under Article 17 as for breach of trust; a citizen who intercepts a porter's sealed message is answerable as for theft or tampering, as the case requires.

Section 3. The Post and the Radio Communications

Messages that may travel by radio or wire, as Information Technology under Article 8 maintains those means, travel by radio relay from one floor to the next, faster than a porter might carry them. Information

Technology maintains a Post office on the Up Top, and satellite Post rooms on key floors, where citizens may send messages by radio or receive messages sent by radio to them.

- (a) Any citizen may send a message by radio through the Post office, provided the message is not forbidden speech under Article 16, and the sender pays a fee in chits to Information Technology for the maintenance of the Post service.
- (b) A message sent by radio is recorded by Information Technology in a log, for the Judicial archive, noting the sender, the recipient, the date, and the time; Information Technology shall not keep the content of private messages, only the fact of their transmission.
- (c) A citizen may petition for privacy in message-sending, and Information Technology may encrypt a message in a cipher maintained by Information Technology alone, so that no citizen save the recipient may read it; such encryption is the charge of Information Technology and may not be undertaken by any citizen or Department save Information Technology.

Section 4. The Freight Lift Log

The freight lift under Article 9 is logged in every use, and the log is kept in the Judicial archive for the record of what goods, ordered by what citizen and carried to what floor, have moved through the silo. This log is not open to citizens, but is audited by Judicial to ensure the lift is not being used contrary to Article 9.

- (a) Every use of the freight lift shall be logged by the operators of the lift under Mechanical's charge: the goods' description and weight, the citizens ordering the lift, the floor of origin, the floor of destination, the date, and the time.
- (b) The log is kept in duplicate: one copy in the Judicial archive, one in the Mechanical records under Article 9. The two copies are compared once per season by Judicial and the Head of Mechanical to ensure they match and no unauthorized use has been made of the lift.

Section 5. The Amendment Log

The roll of amendments to this Pact, ratified by the Assembly under Article 20, is kept as a separate record from the main archive, so that citizens may see how the Pact has changed since its founding. This roll is kept in the Judicial archive and in the backmatter of this Pact itself, under Article 23.

- (a) Every amendment ratified by the Assembly is entered, in order of ratification, in the Amendment Log, with the date of ratification, the text of the amendment, and a statement by the Judge as to whether Judicial found any conflict between the amendment and existing provisions.
- (b) A citizen may view the Amendment Log in the Judicial archive or may read it directly in the Pact's own backmatter, and may petition Judicial for an explanation of any amendment's text.

Article 22

Of Emergency and the Suspension of Ordinary Law

In which is set down what constitutes an emergency that threatens the whole silo, and how the Mayor, Judicial, and the Heads of Departments may act beyond the ordinary Pact to preserve the silo's survival.

Section 1. The Declaration of Emergency

An emergency exists when the silo faces a threat to its survival or the survival of a substantial portion of its citizens: catastrophic damage to the water or air systems, failure of the generator, breach of the outer walls, disease threatening the whole silo, or such other emergency as the Mayor and Judicial jointly determine. In an emergency, ordinary procedures may be set aside, but only by the Mayor and Judicial acting together, and never for longer than one season without renewal of the emergency by Assembly vote.

- (a) The Mayor may declare an emergency and notify Judicial and the Heads of Departments. Judicial may challenge the declaration, and if challenged, Judicial shall rule whether the emergency is genuine, and the ruling is final.
- (b) An emergency suspends this Pact's ordinary procedures for a time set by the Mayor and Judicial jointly, not to exceed one season; if the

emergency continues beyond one season, the Mayor must petition the Assembly for renewal of the emergency, and the Assembly must ratify the renewal by simple majority vote.

- (c) During an emergency, the Mayor may order citizens to work beyond their ordinary labor hours, may redirect resources from one Department to another as the emergency requires, and may restrict citizen movement between floors as necessary to preserve the silo's essential functions.
- (d) During an emergency, Judicial may expedite trials and hearings, may try citizens without the ordinary hearing processes of Article 6, but may not impose sentences beyond those named under Article 17, nor may Judicial clean a citizen for an offense not among the gravest without the Mayor's explicit written order.

Section 2. The Green List and Emergency Protocol

In advance of any known emergency, the Mayor and the Heads of Departments maintain a "green list" protocol, known to Information Technology, Judicial, and Mechanical, setting down in advance what measures must be taken in specific emergencies (the sealing of certain floors, the rationing of water or air, the priority order for use of the generator's power, the emergency shutdown of non-essential systems). This list is updated annually and kept in the Judicial archive.

- (a) A citizen ordered to follow the green list protocol during an emergency shall obey that order as though it were a standing order of the Mayor, and may not refuse or delay the order, save Judicial rules during or after the emergency that the order was not a genuine emergency requirement.
- (b) The green list is not part of this Pact and is not open to citizen review or publication, save where a citizen has appealed an order given under the green list and Judicial is reviewing whether the order was lawful. The green list is maintained in secure archive under Article 21 and its contents and updates are the sole determination of the Mayor and Heads of Departments.
- (c) The green list is maintained by the Mayor in consultation with the Heads of Mechanical, Supply, Information Technology, and Judicial,

and is updated not less than once yearly, in the Assembly's ordinary session, so that the Heads of Departments know the current protocol.

Section 3. The Duration and the End of Emergency

An emergency, once declared, holds for the time set by the Mayor and Judicial. At the end of that time, the emergency is lifted, and the Pact's ordinary procedures resume in full. If the emergency continues, it must be renewed.

- (a) At the end of the time set for the emergency, all extraordinary measures cease, and all citizens released to other duties resume those duties. Any citizen held or assigned to emergency labor shall be reassigned to ordinary labor or compensated for the extraordinary work by the Mayor or the Department concerned.
- (b) An emergency renewed beyond one season requires Assembly ratification; an emergency lasting longer than two seasons must be ratified anew by Assembly vote once per season thereafter.
- (c) Any order given during an emergency that violates this Pact in a way not authorized by the emergency declaration is answerable under Article 17, and a citizen obeying such an order is not punished; the responsibility rests with the officer who gave the unlawful order.

Section 4. Emergency and the Extraordinary Suspension of Article 18

In the gravest emergency, where the silo's survival itself is at stake, the Mayor and Judicial may jointly suspend the requirement that a citizen requesting to go outside be sent to the cleaning. A citizen whose request is suspended under this clause remains in the silo and shall be reassigned to alternative labor as the emergency requires.

- (a) A citizen's final request under Article 18 may be held in abeyance, not suspended, during an emergency, by the Mayor and Judicial jointly, for the duration of the emergency only; a citizen whose request is held in abeyance may renew it at any time after the emergency ends.

- (b) A citizen whose request is held in abeyance may petition Judicial for a ruling that the emergency no longer poses a genuine threat to the silo's survival and that the citizen's request should be honored; Judicial shall rule within one cycle of the petition.
- (c) No citizen's request shall be permanently denied or forgotten; if the emergency lasts longer than the citizen's own life, the citizen's death is recorded in the rolls without the cleaning, and the request is entered in the archive as unfulfilled but not denied.

Section 5. The Necessity and the Restraint

Emergency powers exist to preserve the silo; they are not given to expand the Mayor's or Judicial's authority. A citizen may petition Judicial after an emergency to rule whether any order given during the emergency was necessary to the survival, and Judicial may order compensation or restitution if the order was deemed unnecessary.

- (a) After an emergency ends, Judicial shall, within one season, review any emergency orders given and determine whether they were necessary to the stated emergency purpose. Orders found to be unnecessary or excessive may trigger compensation to citizens harmed by them.
- (b) A citizen who dies or is injured in service to an emergency order determined by Judicial to have been necessary is remembered in the archive, and the citizen's household may petition for compensation under Article 17's restitution provisions.

Article 23

Of Amendment and the Continuance of the Pact

In which is set down that this Pact, though the law that governs the silo, may be altered by the silo's citizens acting together; that no amendment may diminish the rights and protections this Pact gives to every citizen, nor contradict the fundamental necessity of the silo's survival and the equality of its citizens before the law; and that certain provisions stand beyond the Assembly's reach altogether, changeable by no vote and no petition, that the silo's continuance not be undone by well-meant hands.

Section 1. The Process of Amendment

This Pact may be amended by the Assembly, gathered in Assembly under Article 20, upon proposal from the Mayor or petition from one fifth of the silo's citizens of majority. An amendment requires the affirmative vote of two thirds of the Assembly present.

- (a) The text of a proposed amendment shall be made known to all citizens not fewer than fourteen days before the Assembly vote, and citizens shall have the right to speak to the amendment in the Assembly or to send messages under Article 21 raising objections or support.
- (b) An amendment, once ratified, is entered in the Amendment Log maintained under Article 21 and becomes part of this Pact from the day of ratification forward. All earlier editions of this Pact remain in the archive for the record.

- (c) No amendment may be repealed save by a later amendment, ratified in the same manner as the first.

Section 2. The Limits on Amendment

Certain truths are so fundamental to the silo's nature that no amendment may alter them, lest the silo cease to be a place where citizens may live.

- (a) No amendment may eliminate a citizen's right to petition for a final request to go outside, nor may an amendment make that request answerable as an offense under this Pact.
- (b) No amendment may eliminate the lottery for children under Article 3, nor may an amendment increase a citizen's burden of labor beyond the capacity any ordinary citizen might bear.
- (c) No amendment may remove Judicial's right to rule where this Pact is silent, nor may an amendment subordinate Judicial to the Mayor's authority without the Assembly's explicit consent.
- (d) No amendment may eliminate a citizen's right to know the content of this Pact, to view records concerning the citizen under Article 21, or to speak before the Assembly under Article 20.
- (e) No amendment may codify inequality before the law; every citizen shall remain equal under the Pact, save where the Pact itself explicitly provides differences by office, trade, or age.
- (f) No amendment may alter the founding as Article 1 records it, nor compel any Department to disclose the manner, location, or working of any matter this Pact elsewhere commits to that Department's own procedure and does not itself set down.
- (g) An amendment touching any limit named in this section takes no effect upon the Assembly's vote alone. It further requires the written concurrence of the Judge and the Head of Information Technology, given only upon their joint finding that the amendment works none of the harms this section forbids. An amendment lacking such concurrence is void, whatever majority approved it, and is struck from the Log as though never ratified.

Section 3. The Amendment Log

Amendments to this Pact, ratified by the Assembly, are recorded in a separate roll under Article 21 and are printed in the backmatter of this edition of the Pact, under Appendix A, so that any citizen may see how the law has grown and changed.

- (a) Each amendment is entered with the date of ratification, the text of the amendment in full, and a brief notation of what Article or Section it amends or adds.
- (b) The Amendment Log is maintained in the Judicial archive, and a backup copy is kept by the Department of Supply under Article 11.
- (c) Any citizen may petition Judicial to examine the Amendment Log and to ask for an explanation of any amendment's import or consequence.

Section 4. The Continuance and the Renewal of the Pact

This Pact is made for the continuance of the silo and the protection of every citizen who dwells here. It shall endure as long as the silo stands, and shall bind every citizen born or entering the silo until the citizen's death or final release.

- (a) Every citizen of majority takes an oath to know this Pact, to obey it, and to call others to obey it, under Article 2. This oath is binding and sacred.
- (b) The Mayor, the Judge, the Sheriff, and every Head of Department swear at their assumption of office to defend this Pact against those who would breach it, and to enforce this Pact fairly and without favor.
- (c) Should the silo ever cease to stand, or should the citizens ever no longer dwell here, this Pact ends. But while the silo stands and citizens dwell within it, this Pact shall govern, and every citizen shall be bound by it.

Appendix A

Amendment Log

Amendments Ratified Since the Founding

The following amendments have been ratified by the Assembly of the silo since this Pact was first adopted. Each is entered below in the order of its ratification, with the text of the amendment and a note of its effect. The Pact does not itself reckon a calendar from the founding, and this Log follows the Pact’s own practice: an amendment’s place here is fixed by its order, not by a year that binds it to a count no citizen is asked to keep.

Amendment 1: The Housing Proviso

Ratified in the silo’s early years, not long after the offices of this Pact had settled into their ordinary practice.

“Section 1 of Article 14 is amended to add the following clause: ‘A citizen whose dwelling is revoked under this Section may petition Judicial to reduce or stay the revocation, provided the citizen has made a good-faith effort to remedy the breach that occasioned it and sufficient time has passed for remedy to have been possible.’ The remainder of Section 1 is unchanged.”

Effect: Judicial is given explicit discretion to allow remediation before imposing housing revocation. This amendment reflects the principle that citizens are given opportunity to correct small breaches before suffering larger penalties.

Amendment 2: The Retirement Entitlement

Ratified a generation after Amendment 1.

“Article 19, Section 5 is amended to require that a retired citizen receive, in addition to the ordinary ration, a medicine stipend adequate to the cost of common treatments, and that the Infirmary provide the same care to a retired citizen as to a citizen still in labor. The remainder of Article 19 is unchanged.”

Effect: Retired citizens are guaranteed medication and continued medical care rather than left to purchase such care from their ration chits.

Amendment 3: The Appeal of Judicial Sentence

Ratified some years further on.

“Article 6, Section 4 is amended to add: ‘A citizen sentenced to the mines under Article 17 may petition Judicial to review the sentence once the citizen has served half the term originally set, and the Judge may shorten the remainder of the term if the citizen has demonstrated good conduct and honest labor throughout the sentence’s duration, or if material new evidence has emerged bearing on the citizen’s guilt. No such review shall reduce a sentence’s total length by more than half of what was originally imposed.’ The remainder is unchanged.”

Effect: Citizens in the mines are given a pathway to early release at the midpoint of good behavior, though no sentence may be halved more than once, and the core of every sentence must still be served.

Amendment 4: The Right to Counsel

Ratified in the years following Amendment 3.

“Article 6, Section 4 is amended to add: ‘A citizen accused of an offense not among the gravest named under Article 17 may request that another citizen be permitted to speak on the accused’s behalf before Judicial, that the Judicial hearing not be conducted in isolation. Judicial shall grant such request, provided the speaking-citizen is not themselves under prosecution and has not been barred from Assembly by prior judgment.’ The remainder is unchanged.”

Effect: Citizens are permitted advocates in non-gravest trials, though the form and scope of advocacy remain within Judicial’s discretion.

Amendment 5: The Syndromic Retirement

Ratified well after Amendment 4, in a season this Log does not further mark.

“Article 13, Section 8 is amended to add: ‘A citizen diagnosed with the Syndrome may petition for retirement under the same process as any other citizen seeking to leave labor, without waiting for the age at which retirement is ordinarily granted. The Head Physician and the Mayor shall approve such petition within one month of its filing.’ The remainder is unchanged.”

Effect: Citizens with the Syndrome are permitted to seek retirement at any age if their condition makes continued labor untenable.

Amendment 6: The Floor Reassignment Procedure

Ratified some time after Amendment 5.

“Article 14, Section 2 is amended such that: ‘A citizen may petition the Head of Supply for reassignment to a different floor’s housing, and the Head of Supply shall consider such petition with regard to the citizen’s trade, the silo’s current needs, and the space available on the requested floor. A denial of such petition may be appealed to Judicial, though Judicial shall confirm the decision provided the Head of Supply’s reasoning is rational and based on legitimate silo need.’ The remainder is unchanged.”

Effect: Citizens gain a formal right to petition for floor reassignment, with Judicial review available for denials.

Amendment 7: The Assembly Quorum Reduction

Ratified later still.

“Article 20, Section 1 is amended: ‘An extraordinary Assembly session to address a matter of urgent silo need may proceed with a quorum of not fewer than one third of the silo’s population of majority, provided the session has been called in accordance with this Article and all citizens have been given not fewer than seven days’ notice.’ The remainder is unchanged.”

Effect: Extraordinary assemblies require fewer citizens present, allowing for faster decision-making in time-sensitive matters. The ordinary Assembly, to which any citizen of majority may come or send a message under this Article, is unaffected.

Amendment 8: The Reporting of Anomalous Signal and Device

Ratified last of those entered in this Log, at the recommendation of the Department of Information Technology, following a matter the Department represented to the Assembly as touching the whole silo’s safety. The

Assembly's own record of the deliberation preceding the vote does not survive in the Judicial archive in complete form; what is reproduced below is reconstructed from the surviving fragments and the Judge's own summary, entered afterward at Judicial's own insistence that no amendment stand in this Log without some account of its passage.

"Article 16, Section 6 is amended to add: 'Where Information Technology represents to Judicial that a device, signal, or apparatus discovered by a citizen may bear upon matters this Pact does not commit to public record, the citizen who discovers it shall report the discovery to Information Technology directly, and shall not first report it to the Sheriff or to Judicial, notwithstanding any other provision of this Article; and the citizen shall thereafter answer such questions as Information Technology puts to the citizen concerning the manner, place, and circumstance of the discovery. This is not to be understood as a diminishment of Judicial's charge to investigate offenses under this Pact, but as a necessary sequencing of that investigation, that the silo's safety not be made to wait upon a report reaching Information Technology only after having passed through other hands. No citizen who complies with this Section in good faith shall be found to have violated the ordinary reporting requirement this Section otherwise imposes, whatever the outcome of Information Technology's own review proves to be.' The remainder of Article 16 is unchanged."

Effect: A discovery a citizen might once have carried first to the Sheriff or to Judicial is now carried first to Information Technology, and the report of the incident that prompted this amendment does not survive to say what was found. The concurrence Article 23 requires of the Judge and the Head of Information Technology together, for any amendment touching what this Pact keeps from ordinary record, was given here by both offices without recorded dissent. Whether that concurrence was a check upon the amendment, or simply the agreement of the two offices best placed to benefit from it, is a question this Log does not answer.

Amendment 9: The Narrowing of the Right to Counsel

Ratified after Amendment 8, in a season the Assembly's own call to vote described only as necessary to the Pact's continued good order, without further particular given.

"Article 6, Section 4, as amended by Amendment 4, is further amended: 'The right granted by Amendment 4 to bring a speaking-citizen before Judicial does not extend to an offense under Article 16, Sections 1, 3, 5, or 6, it being the judgment of the Assembly that a hearing upon such an offense ought not be made an occasion for the very speech, teaching, relic, or discovery those Sections forbid.' The remainder of Article 6, Section 4

is unchanged.”

Effect: A citizen accused of the forbidden word, the false teaching of the founding, the keeping of a restricted instrument, or the tampering with a monitoring device may no longer bring a speaking-citizen to the hearing Amendment 4 otherwise grants. The Assembly’s record of its own reasoning is thinner here than for any amendment before it; whether the narrowing answered some particular occasion, or only the fear of one, this Log does not say.

Unamended Provisions

The following provisions of the Pact have not been amended since its founding and remain in their original form:

- Article 1: Of the Founding and Purpose of the Silo
- Article 2: Of Citizenship and the Census
- Article 3: Of Marriage, the Lottery, and the Right of Birth
- Article 4: Of the Office of Mayor
- Article 5: Of the Deputy Mayor and the Order of Succession
- Article 7: Of the Sheriff and the Keeping of the Peace
- Article 8: Of the Department of Information Technology
- Article 9: Of the Department of Mechanical
- Article 10: Of the Department of Mines
- Article 11: Of Supply, Hydroponics, and the Ration
- Article 12: Of Trade, Chits, and Commerce
- Article 15: Of Schooling and the Teaching of the Young
- Article 17: Of Crimes and Their Punishments
- Article 18: Of the Cleaning
- Article 21: Of Records, Porters, and the Post
- Article 22: Of Emergency and the Suspension of Ordinary Law
- Article 23: Of Amendment and the Continuance of the Pact

The fact that an Article remains unamended does not indicate that it is unchanging or unchangeable—only that no amendment ratified by Assembly has yet altered it. The founding principles of the Pact remain firm; the amendments recorded above show how the silo’s citizens have chosen to clarify, extend, restrict, and occasionally soften the Pact’s application over time.